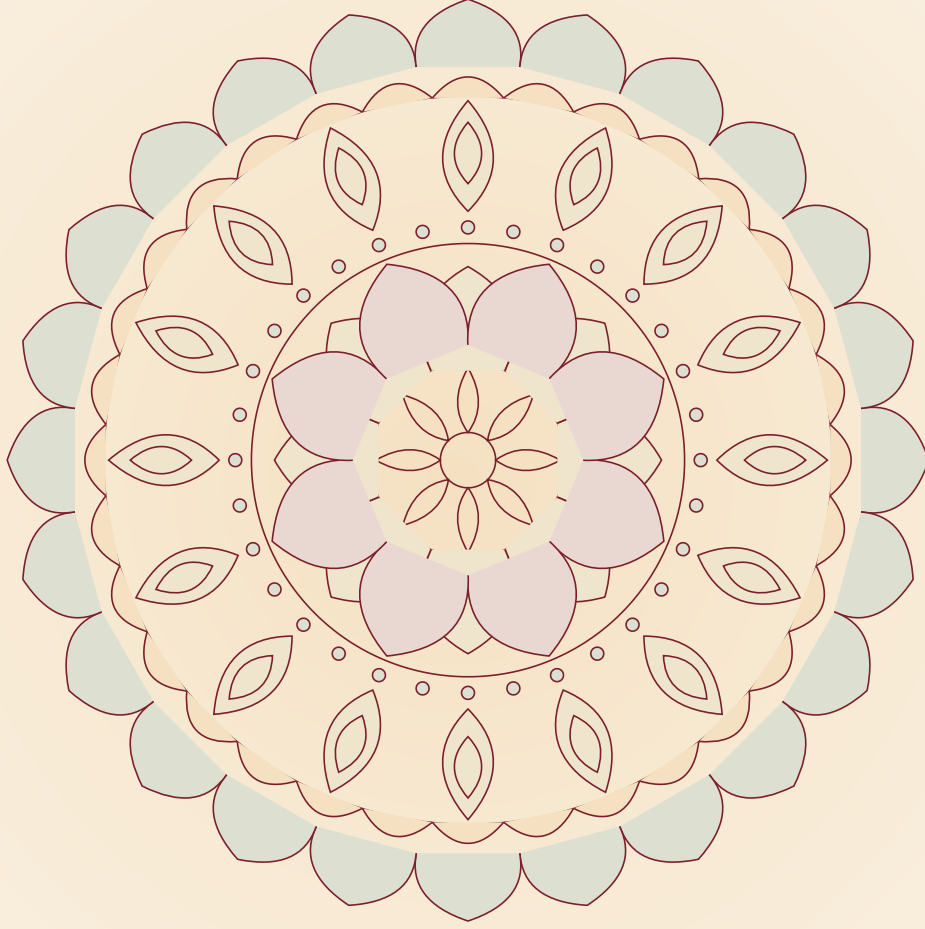


A 40-WEEK WORKBOOK FOR MOTHER & FAMILY



Garbha Gyan

गर्भ ज्ञान

A 40-Week Journey of Mind, Body & Spirit



PRENATAL SCIENCE · INDIA'S GARBHA SAMSKĀRA HERITAGE

सर्वे भवन्तु सुखिनः

May all be happy



This book belongs to



Mother's name

Partner's name

Baby's nickname

Due date

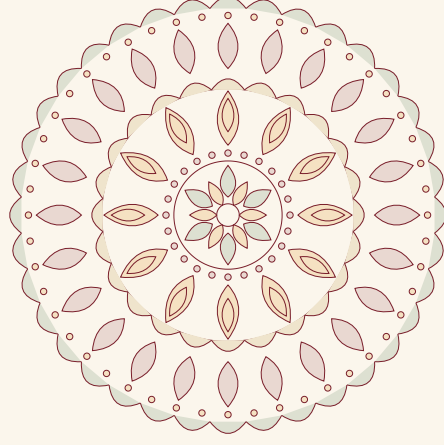
We began this journey on

For you, little one —

Write a few words to your baby. You will read them together one day.

Handwriting practice lines consisting of ten horizontal lines.





Garbha Gyan

गर्भ ज्ञान

A 40-Week Journey of Mind, Body & Spirit

A workbook for mother, partner and family

ॐ पूर्णमदः पूर्णमिदं पूर्णात्पूर्णमुदच्यते ।
पूर्णस्य पूर्णमादाय पूर्णमेवावशिष्यते ॥

*om pūrṇam adaḥ pūrṇam idaṁ pūrṇāt pūrṇam udacyate |
pūrṇasya pūrṇam ādāya pūrṇam evāvaśiṣyate ॥*

That is whole; this is whole. From wholeness, wholeness comes forth. When wholeness is taken from wholeness, wholeness remains. — A beautiful image for a mother: a whole new life comes from you, and you remain whole.

Bṛhadāraṇyaka Upaniṣad 5.1.1; Īśa Upaniṣad (invocation)

Edition: 1.0 (draft for expert review) · A4 · full colour · full

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How to use this book

Each week has five small invitations — for your mind, body, heart, spirit and plate. Every one was chosen because it can support your baby's growth through your wellbeing, closeness and senses, and help calm your mind. Do what feels good. Skip freely. Little and often is better than perfect.

Five strands

 **Mind** read · sing · chant · story

Read, talk, sing, chant or tell a story — your voice is baby's first music.

 **Body** gentle movement & breath

Gentle, doctor-approved movement and breathing.

 **Heart** journal · gratitude · partner

Journal, gratitude, letters to baby, and a partner task.

 **Spirit** mandala · yantra · mudrā · silence

Colour, trace, gaze, rest your hands in a mudrā, or sit in silence.

 **Nourish** food for two

A brain-supportive food of the week with a simple Indian recipe and food-safety notes.

Evidence badges

- Science-backed: supported by good studies or major guidelines (nutrition, sleep, stress reduction, safe movement, talking and singing to baby).
- Emerging evidence: early or modest research, mostly about the mother's calm (music, mantra, meditation, bonding).
- ✦ Tradition & culture: India's heritage shared with respect and its source named — not a medical claim.

2 min **5 min** **10 min** **20 min** Time chips show roughly how long an activity takes: 2, 5, 10 or 20 minutes.

At the bottom of each week: circle your mood, note sleep, baby's movements, water and energy, and take one calm minute.

Our promise — This book never promises a 'genius', a particular look, or a boy or a girl. It offers care, calm and connection — which is what babies and mothers truly need.

A note on health, safety and respect



This book is for wellbeing and connection. It does not replace antenatal care. Please attend all your check-ups, take the supplements your doctor prescribes, and ask before starting any new physical activity, breathing practice or diet change.

Every BODY and NOURISH activity carries two reminders: Check with your doctor first, and Stop if... Some pregnancies need extra care — for example with bleeding, a low-lying placenta, twins, high blood pressure, diabetes or a history of early labour. Your doctor will tell you what is right for you.

Breath practices here are gentle only. We do not include breath-holding (kumbhaka), kapālabhāti, bhastrikā, inversions, deep backbends, lying on the belly, hot yoga, or herbal and Ayurvedic medicines — these are not safe to self-prescribe in pregnancy.

Classical texts are shared as heritage. Where they describe diets, herbs or procedures, we summarise them as history only. Some old customs are based on fear (such as eclipse restrictions); they have no scientific basis and are not included.

Choosing or predicting a baby's sex is illegal in India (PC&PNDT Act, 1994) and has no basis in science. Nothing in this book — no ritual, food or chant — affects a baby's sex, skin colour, looks or intelligence.

Inclusivity — Rooted in India, open to all. This book draws on Hindu, Buddhist, Jain and folk traditions of India, and it welcomes families of every faith and of none. Every spiritual activity has a secular alternative (next page). Use what speaks to you; leave the rest with a smile.

Disclaimer: The authors and publishers accept no liability for the use of this book. Information is general and may not suit every pregnancy. Content flagged for review should be checked by an obstetrician, an Ayurvedic physician and a Sanskrit scholar before distribution.

Choose your own path



Every spiritual practice in this book has an equal, secular twin. The calming effect mostly comes from slow breath, gentle attention and loving connection — available to everyone.

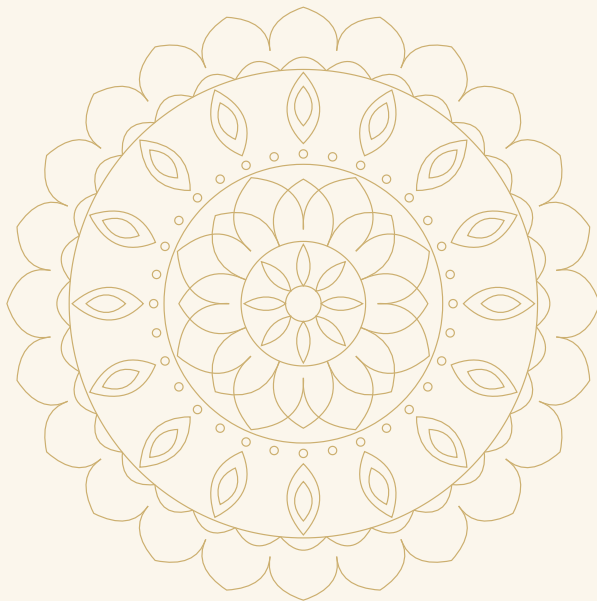
✦ SPIRITUAL PRACTICE	🕒 SECULAR TWIN
Chanting Om̐	Humming one comfortable note
Gāyatrī / Śānti mantras	A favourite poem or prayer of your own faith, read slowly
Madālasā's lullaby	A lullaby from your own family
Yantra steady gaze	Soft gaze at a flower or geometric pattern
Tracing the Śrī Yantra	Colouring a geometric pattern
Mudrā with breath	Hands resting on your belly while you breathe
Cakra check-in	Head-to-toe feelings check
Pañca Kośa check-in	Five-question wellbeing check
Family blessing (āśīrvāda)	Family wishes for baby
Anulom vilom / bhrāmarī	Counted breathing (4 in, 6 out) / humming a tune

Three settings

Full: Everything as printed.

Light: Keeps the art, mudrās and peace mantras; cakra and yantra practices become their secular twins.

Secular: Every spiritual activity is replaced by its twin. Rebuild the book with the 'secular' setting.



Your path: tick one:

☐ Full

☐ Light

☐ Secular

☐ My own mix

When to call your doctor immediately

Go to hospital or call for help straight away if you notice any of these. Do not wait until morning.



1. Bleeding or spotting from the vagina, at any stage

2. Fluid leaking or gushing from the vagina

3. Baby moving less, differently, or not at all (from about 24 weeks)

4. Severe headache, blurred vision or seeing spots

5. Sudden swelling of the face, hands or feet

6. Fits (convulsions) or fainting

7. High fever (38 °C / 100.4 °F or more), or fever with chills

8. Severe or continuing pain in the belly, or regular tightening before 37 weeks

9. Vomiting so much you cannot keep water down

10. Difficulty breathing, chest pain or a racing heart

11. Pain, redness or swelling in one calf

12. Burning or pain when passing urine, or foul-smelling discharge

13. Thoughts of harming yourself or your baby, or feeling unable to cope

Ambulance

108

Mother & child transport (many states)

102

Tele-MANAS (mental health, 24×7)

14416

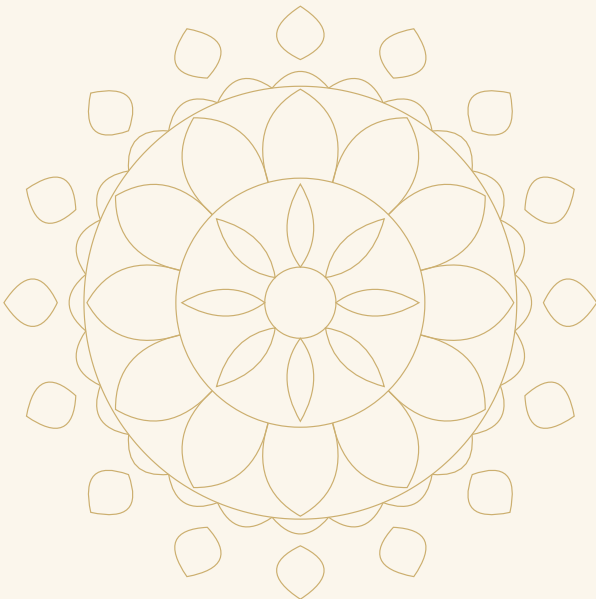
My doctor

Hospital

Hospital phone

ASHA / ANM

Trust your instinct. If something feels wrong, it is always right to call.



Based on the MoHFW Mother & Child Protection Card (2018), WHO (2016) and ACOG (2020). Numbers to be re-checked before printing.

Your journey: what science sees

How your baby’s senses and brain develop across the three trimesters

	TRIMESTER 1 · WEEKS 1–13	TRIMESTER 2 · WEEKS 14–27	TRIMESTER 3 · WEEKS 28–40
Brain	Neural tube forms and closes by week 6; brain regions begin.	Rapid growth of nerve cells; brain grows larger and more active.	Surface folds into ridges; connections multiply — and keep growing for years after birth.
Hearing	Ear structures begin to form.	First responses to sound around 19 weeks; low tones first.	Knows familiar voices; newborns prefer their mother’s voice.
Touch	Mouth area responds to touch around 8 weeks.	Responds to touch all over; moves more when you stroke your belly.	Grasps, sucks thumb, explores the face and cord.
Taste & smell	Taste buds start forming (weeks 8–13).	Swallows amniotic fluid, which carries flavours of your food.	May later accept flavours met in the womb more easily.
Movement	Tiny movements from about week 7 (not felt).	Flutters felt between 16 and 24 weeks.	Strong kicks; a pattern you can learn. Movements should not slow down before birth.

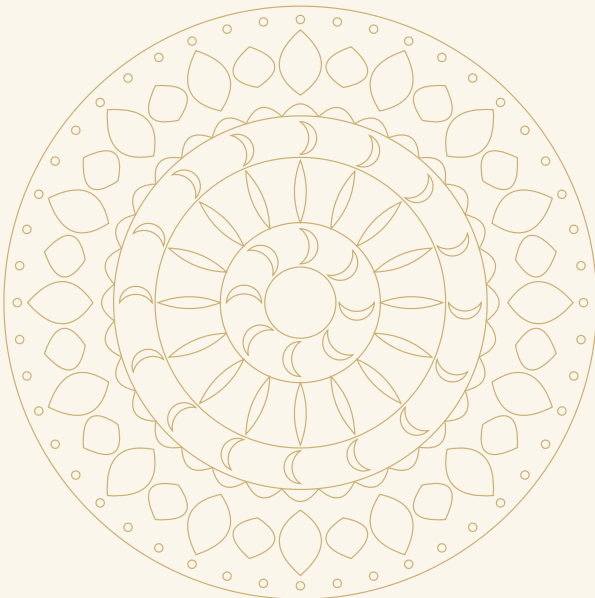


Sources: Hepper & Shahidullah 1994; DeCasper & Fifer 1980; Kisilevsky 2003; Marx & Nagy 2015; Mennella 2001; RCOG 2011; Moore, The Developing Human.

What the sages observed

Classical Indian descriptions of the growing baby, beside modern findings. Shared as heritage — the ancient texts and modern science use different methods and should not be equated.

MONTH	CLASSICAL TEXTS (SUMMARY)	WHAT SCIENCE SEES TODAY
1	Garbha Upaniṣad: after one night a jelly (kalala), after seven nights a bubble. Caraka: kalala.	Fertilisation, implantation; three cell layers form.
2	Caraka: becomes solid (ghana). Garbha Up.: the head forms.	Neural tube closes; heart beats; limb buds.
3	Caraka: all limbs and senses appear together. Garbha Up.: the feet.	Fetal period begins; organs formed; fingers and toes.
4	Suśruta: the heart becomes manifest; the mother is 'two-hearted' and has cravings (dauhṛda).	Heartbeat easily heard; baby moves arms and legs.
5	Suśruta: the mind (manas) becomes more awake.	Flutters felt; first responses to sound.
6	Suśruta: the intellect (buddhi) develops.	Rapid brain growth; responds to touch and sound.
7	Suśruta: all limbs clearly formed. Garbha Up.: quickened with life.	Eyes open; sleep-wake cycles.
8	Suśruta: ojas (vital essence) is unsteady.	Fat stores, lungs maturing; brain surface folds.
9	Garbha Up.: complete in every part.	Full term from 37 weeks; ready to meet you.



✦ Sources: Caraka Saṃhitā Śārīrasthāna 4; Suśruta Saṃhitā Śārīrasthāna 3; Garbha Upaniṣad. Verse references need verification by a Sanskrit scholar.

What is Garbha Saṃskāra?

Garbha means womb and saṃskāra means a refining rite or impression. Together, garbha saṃskāra names India's old and living idea that a mother's food, feelings, surroundings and sounds matter to the child she carries — and that a pregnancy deserves care, celebration and calm.

Ayurveda's classical texts — the Caraka and Suśruta Saṃhitās (roughly 2,000 years old) — describe garbhiṇī paricaryā, care of the pregnant woman. Suśruta advises that from the very first day she should be 'ever joyful, clean, adorned, dressed in light clothes, and devoted to peace and auspicious acts'. Modern research on maternal stress agrees that a mother's wellbeing matters.

Today the National Institute of Ayurveda (Ministry of AYUSH) teaches garbha saṃskāra as care through diet, lifestyle, yoga, meditation, mantra and music, complementing — not replacing — modern antenatal care.

The pregnancy saṃskāras

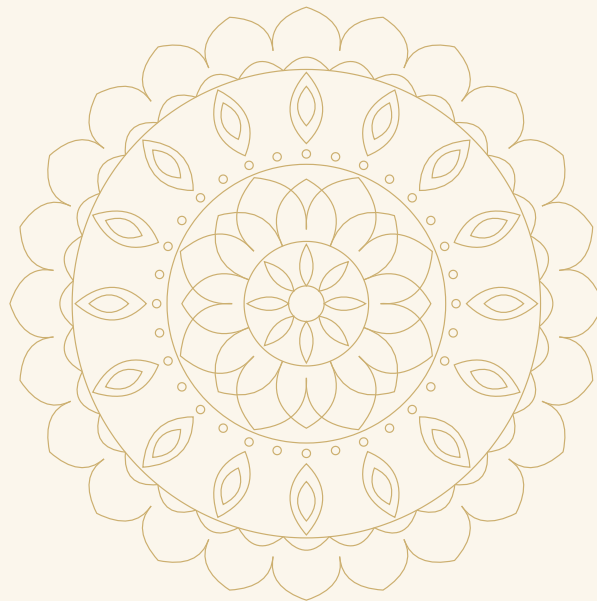
Garbhādhāna. Rite around conception — here, simply a heartfelt intention (saṅkalpa).

Puṃsavana. An old 3rd-month rite that once wished for a son. We reject that aim: sex selection is illegal (PC&PNDT Act) and unscientific. Many families now mark the month with a blessing for a healthy child — whoever they are.

Śimantonayana. The parting of the mother's hair with music and blessings (Āśvalāyana Gṛhya Sūtra 1.14) — ancestor of godh bharai, śīmantham, valaikāppu, sādḥ and dohāḷe jevaṇ.

What this book will never claim

- ✗ That any practice raises IQ or creates a 'genius'
- ✗ That skin colour, looks or height can be shaped
- ✗ That anything can choose or predict a boy or a girl
- ✗ That rituals replace medical care



Some modern programmes have made such claims; they have been widely criticised as unscientific. Sources: Suśruta Śā. 10/3; NIA 2024; Pandey 1969.

Tradition & evidence

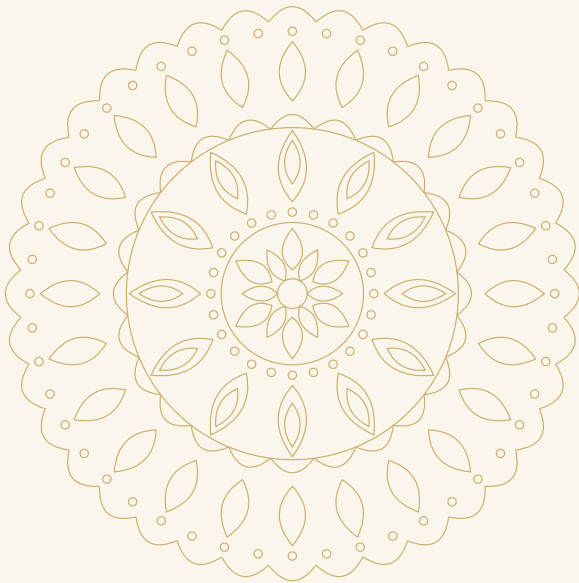
What is — and isn't — proven



Our ancestors noticed much that science now confirms: babies hear in the womb; a mother’s calm matters; good food and rest are foundations. Other beliefs have not been tested, or were based on fear. Here is an honest map.

BELIEF OR PRACTICE	WHAT WE KNOW
● Babies hear and learn familiar voices in the womb.	Proven (from ~19–24 weeks). It builds familiarity, not intelligence.
● A mother’s calm and support matter.	Proven association; stress-reduction helps mothers.
● Good food, rest and gentle movement.	Strong evidence — plus iron, folate, iodine and food safety.
🕒 Music, mantra, meditation, yoga for calm.	Encouraging but small or mixed studies — for the mother.
✦ Yantras, cakras, mudrās, rituals.	Contemplative and cultural — no medical effect claimed.
⊗ Taboos, ‘designer baby’ claims, sex selection.	No evidence; harmful or illegal — not included.

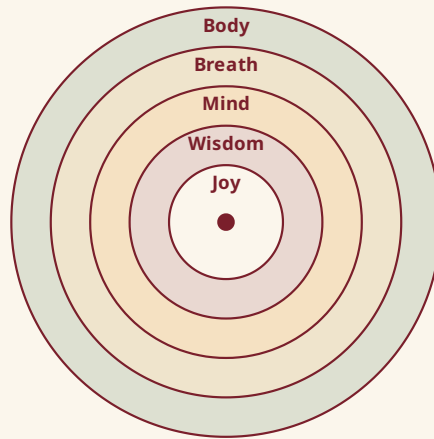
● Science-backed 🕒 Emerging evidence ✦ Tradition & culture ⊗ Not included



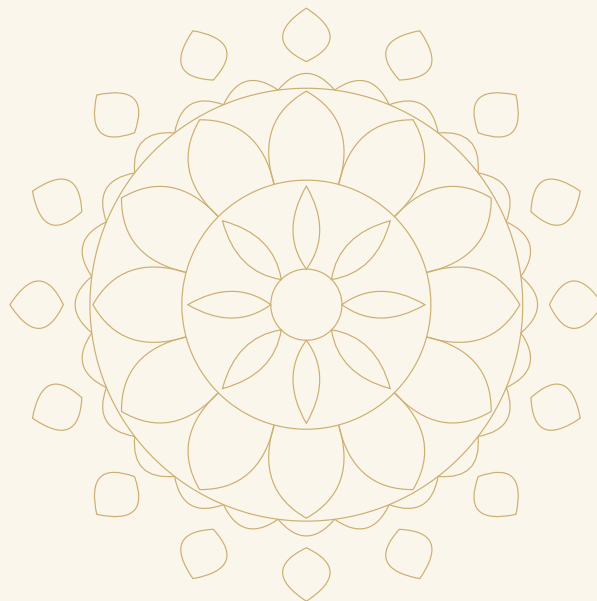
Full table on page 86.

Pañca Kośa — five layers of care

The Taittirīya Upaniṣad (2.1–2.5) describes five ‘sheaths’, from the body inward to joy. We use them as a gentle self-care check-in.



KOŚA	LAYER	CHECK-IN QUESTION	IN THIS BOOK
Annamaya अन्नमय	Body — food	What does my body need today: rest, water, food, movement?	Nourish & Body pages
Prāṇamaya प्राणमय	Breath — energy	Is my breath easy? Three slow breaths.	Belly breathing
Manomaya मनोमय	Mind — feelings	What am I feeling? Name it kindly.	Heart pages
Vijñānamaya विज्ञानमय	Wisdom — knowing	What do I know is true for me and baby?	Wisdom lines
Ānandamaya आनन्दमय	Joy — bliss	What made me smile today?	Spirit pages

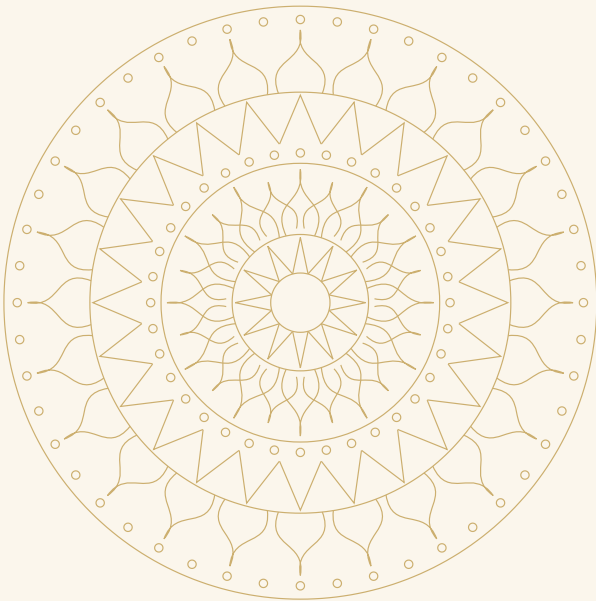


In the Upaniṣad this is a teaching on the Self; here it is offered as a simple framework for care. (♦ Tradition & culture)

The seven cakras — a symbolic map

Use this map to check in with your feelings. It comes from the tantric tradition (Śaṭ-cakra-nirūpaṇa, 1577) — it is symbolic, not anatomy, and not a medical system. The rainbow colours are a modern convention.

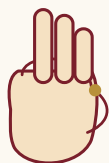
CAKRA	PLACE	PETALS	BĪJA	QUALITY	CALMING AFFIRMATION
 Sahasrāra सहस्रार	crown	1000	—	Connection, peace	<i>I am part of something larger than me.</i>
 Ājñā आज्ञा	brow	2	ॐ	Insight, intuition	<i>I trust my inner knowing.</i>
 Viśuddha विशुद्ध	throat	16	हं	Voice, expression	<i>My voice is my baby's first song.</i>
 Anāhata अनाहत	heart	12	यं	Love, compassion	<i>My heart has room for us both.</i>
 Maṇipūra मणिपूर	navel	10	रं	Strength, warmth	<i>I have the strength I need, one day at a time.</i>
 Svādhiṣṭhāna स्वाधिष्ठान	pelvis	6	वं	Flow, creativity	<i>I flow with the changes in my body.</i>
 Mūlādhāra मूलाधार	base	4	लं	Safety, grounding	<i>I am safe, supported and held.</i>



✦ Tradition & culture · Secular twin: head-to-toe feelings check. Source: Pūrṇānanda, Śaṭ-cakra-nirūpaṇa (1577); Woodroffe, The Serpent Power (1919).

Mudrās — gentle hand gestures

Hand gestures from ritual, classical dance and meditation. Rest the hands comfortably and breathe slowly for 2 minutes. Healing claims made for mudrās are not proven — enjoy them as a way to focus and settle.



Jñāna mudrā

Tips of thumb and index finger touch; other fingers relaxed.
Steady attention; a classic meditation gesture.



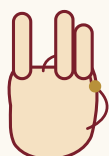
Dhyāna mudrā

Right hand resting in the left, palms up, thumbs touching, in the lap.
Stillness and rest.



Añjali mudrā

Palms together at the heart (namaste).
Gratitude and greeting.



Śūnya / Śuni mudrā

Thumb tip touches the middle fingertip.
Patience (as described in modern yoga).



Prāṇa mudrā

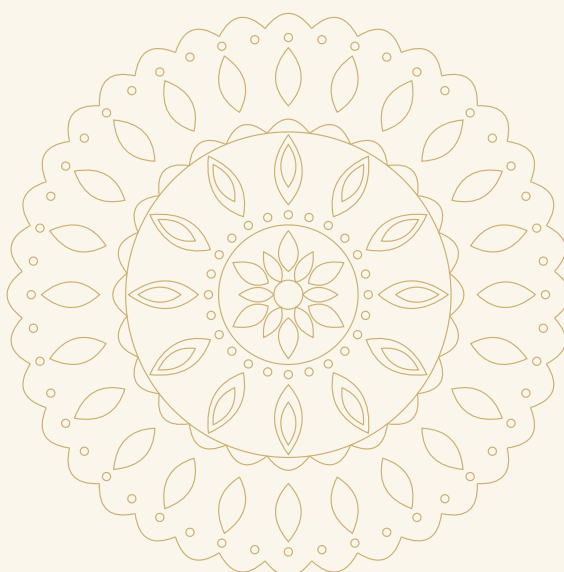
Thumb touches the tips of the ring and little fingers.
Vitality (as described in modern yoga).



Apāna mudrā

Thumb touches the tips of the middle and ring fingers.
Traditionally kept for the last weeks (from about 36 weeks) — a custom only; the gesture itself is harmless.

2-minute practice: sit comfortably, choose a mudrā, rest the hands on the thighs or belly, and breathe slowly — longer out than in. Notice the touch of the fingertips. **2 min**

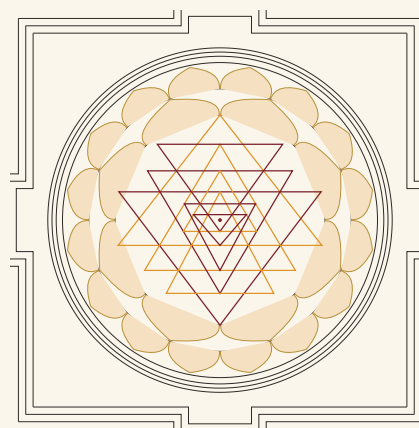


Yantras & the Śrī Yantra

A yantra is a geometric diagram for contemplation. The most celebrated is the Śrī Yantra (Śrī Cakra) of the Śrī Vidyā tradition: nine interlocking triangles — four pointing up and five pointing down — weave together to form 43 smaller triangles around a central point, the bindu. Around them bloom lotuses of eight and sixteen petals, three circles and a square ‘gateway’ (bhūpura).

The upward and downward triangles are traditionally read as the meeting of Śiva and Śakti — consciousness and creative energy. Many see in it an image of creation itself: a whole universe unfolding from a single point. For a mother, it can be a quiet picture of life growing from a seed.

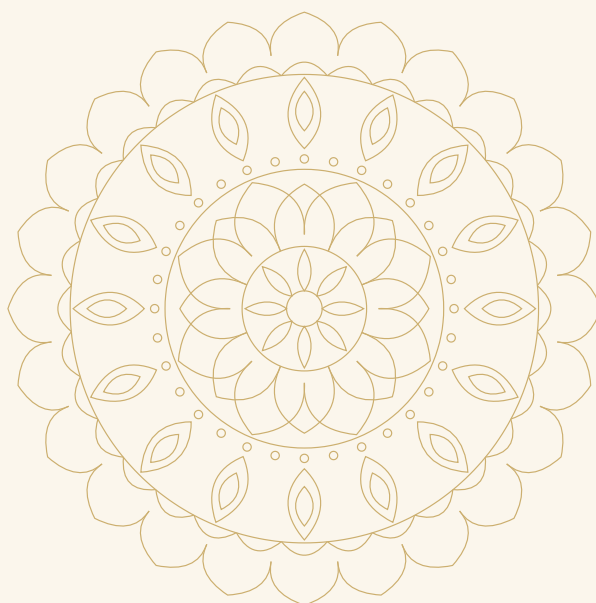
Drawing the Śrī Yantra accurately is famously difficult: several lines must meet at exactly the same points. The yantra on the next page was calculated by computer to meet these conditions closely.



Soft steady gaze (trāṭaka-lite)

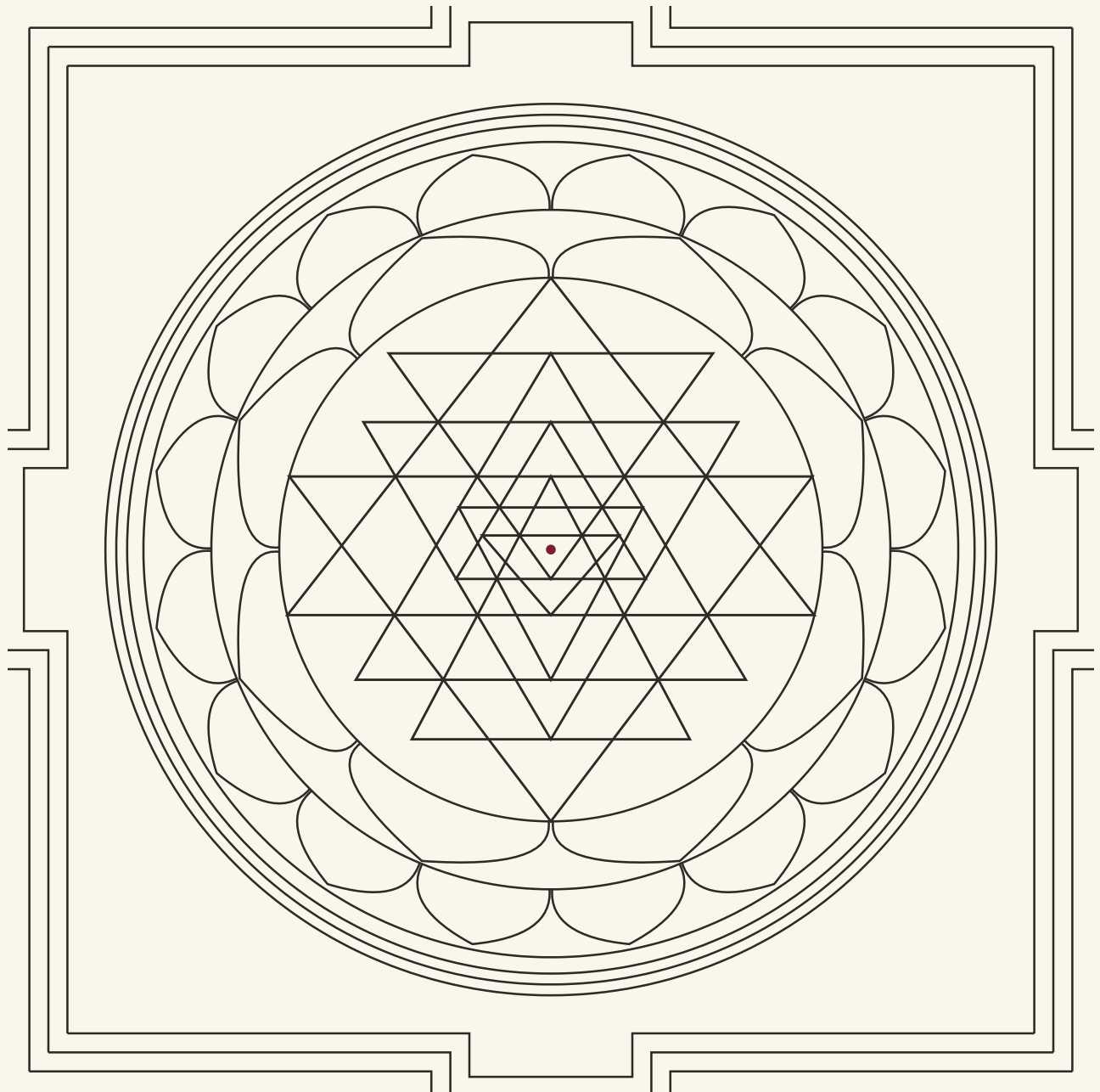
1. Sit comfortably with the yantra at eye level, about an arm's length away.
2. Rest your eyes softly on the central dot. Blink whenever you need to.
3. After 1–3 minutes, close your eyes and rest, palms over the eyes if you like.

Safety: Never strain or stare. Blink normally; stop if your eyes water or ache. No candle-gazing for long periods.



Śrī Yantra — trace & colour

Trace the triangles slowly with a pencil, then colour from the outside in. End by resting your gaze at the centre.



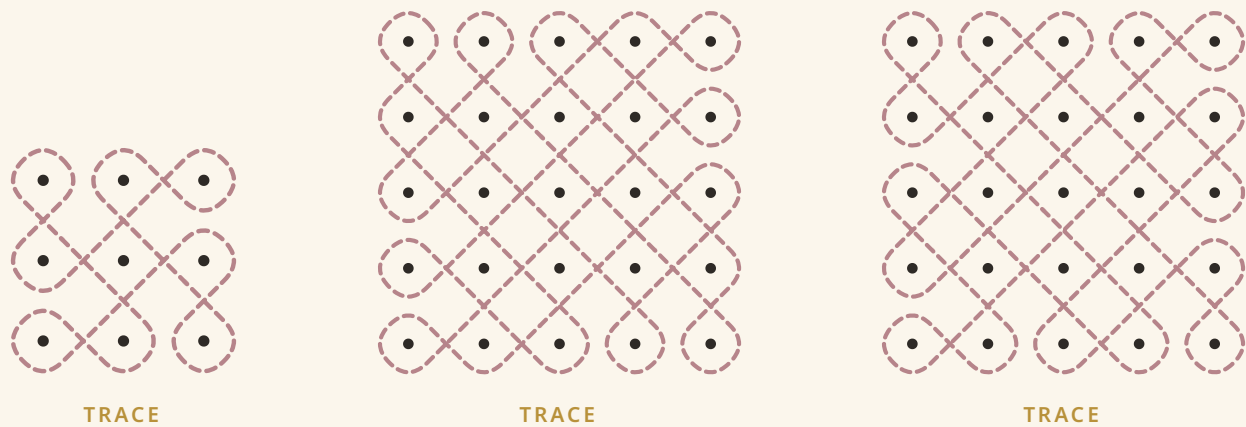
✦ Geometry solved in code: all 22 incidence conditions (apexes on bases, corners on lines, triple meeting points) hold to within 10^{-12} .
 Secular twin: colour it simply as geometry.

Kolam & rangoli — lines around dots

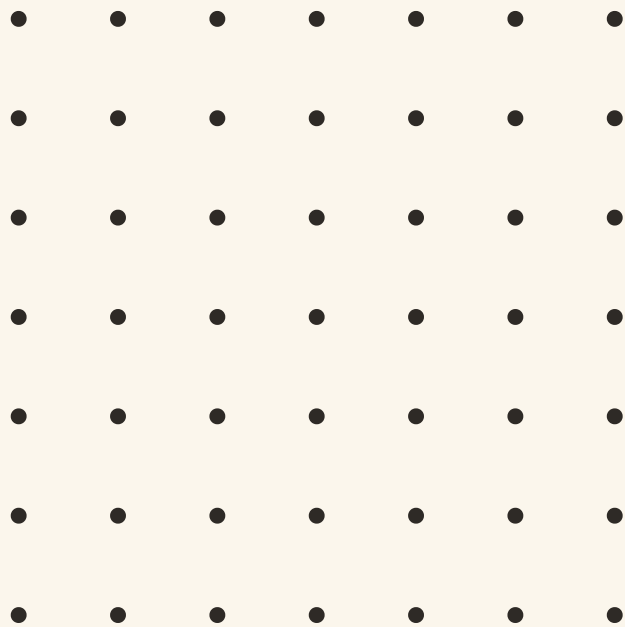


Every dawn across South India, women draw kolam at the threshold with rice flour — loops woven around a grid of dots (pulli). Rangoli (Maharashtra, Gujarat), alpana (Bengal), muggulu (Andhra & Telangana) and mandana (Rajasthan) are its cousins. Mathematicians have studied kolam as elegant closed curves; families see them as welcome, beauty and care.

Trace the patterns below, then try your own on the empty grid. One continuous line, looping around the dots, slow and unhurried. A wobble is part of the beauty.



YOUR TURN



◆ Tradition & culture · ● Repetitive drawing may help calm attention. Each traced kolam is one continuous loop (verified in code).

Sound & mantra

How to chant — or hum — safely and calmly



How to chant (or hum)

- 1. Sit comfortably, supported; shoulders soft.
- 2. Breathe in gently through the nose — never strain.
- 3. Let the sound ride on a slow out-breath; then breathe normally.
- 4. Never hold the breath. Use a soft voice. Stop if dizzy or tired.
- 5. 3, 5 or 9 repetitions are plenty. Silence afterwards is part of the practice.



om̐ (a – u – m)

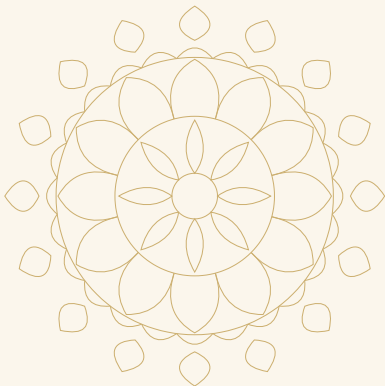
The sacred syllable of the Upaniṣads and the Yoga Sūtra (1.27: ‘its expression is the sacred syllable’). Chanted softly, it is simply a long, gentle out-breath that ends in a hum.

Secular twin: Hum one comfortable note: ‘mmm’.

Pronunciation key (IAST)

<i>ā ī ū</i>	long vowels: father, police, rule
<i>ṛ</i>	as ‘ri’ in rich (lightly rolled)
<i>ṁ</i>	nasal hum: as ‘ng/m’
<i>ḥ</i>	a soft echo of breath: śāntiḥ ≈ ‘shaantihi’
<i>ś ṣ</i>	both ‘sh’; ṣ with tongue curled back
<i>ṭ ḍ ṇ</i>	tongue curled back (retroflex)
<i>c</i>	‘ch’ as in church
<i>jñ</i>	‘gy’ or ‘jny’ (jñāna ≈ gyaana)
<i>e o</i>	always long: ‘ay’, ‘oh’

What the research says: chanting and humming slow the breath and lengthen the exhalation, which is linked with calm. Studies are small (an fMRI pilot of Om̐ chanting; a very-low-quality review of bhrāmarī). There is no evidence that mantras shape a baby’s character or intelligence — their gift is a calmer, more connected mother. (Emerging evidence)



Sources: Kalyani 2011; Kuppusamy 2018; Bernardi 2001; Lynch 2018.

Gāyatrī & Śānti mantras

Read the meaning first. Recite slowly, softly, without holding the breath.



Gāyatrī mantra

ॐ भूर्भुवः स्वः ।

तत्सवितुर्वरेण्यं भर्गो देवस्य धीमहि ।

धियो यो नः प्रचोदयात् ॥

om bhūr bhuvaḥ svaḥ |

tat savitur vareṇyam bhargo devasya dhīmahi |

dhiyo yo naḥ pracodayāt ||

Meaning: We meditate on the radiant light of the divine Sun (Savitr); may it inspire and brighten our minds.

Some families follow initiation customs for this mantra; please follow yours. Listening, or choosing another prayer, is equally welcome.

🕉 **Secular twin:** Read a short poem or prayer you love, slowly, three times.

Rgveda 3.62.10

Saha nāvavatu — together

ॐ सह नावतु । सह नौ भुनक्तु ।

सह वीर्यं करवावहै ।

तेजस्वि नावधीतमस्तु मा विद्विषावहै ॥

ॐ शान्तिः शान्तिः शान्तिः ॥

om saha nāv avatu | saha nau bhunaktu |

saha vīryam karavāvahai |

tejasvi nāv adhītam astu mā vidviṣāvahai ||

om śāntiḥ śāntiḥ śāntiḥ ||

Meaning: May we two be protected together; may we be nourished together; may we grow strong together; may our learning shine; may there be no ill-will between us. Peace, peace, peace. — Traditionally said by teacher and student; here, by mother and baby: ‘we two’.

🕉 **Secular twin:** Say: ‘May we two be safe. May we two be well. May we grow together.’

Taittirīya Upaniṣad 2.1 (invocation); Kaṭha Upaniṣad

Asato mā — towards light

असतो मा सद्गमय ।

तमसो मा ज्योतिर्गमय ।

मृत्योर्मा अमृतं गमय ॥

asato mā sad gamaya |

tamaso mā jyotir gamaya |

mṛtyor mā amṛtaṁ gamaya ||

Meaning: Lead me from the unreal to the real; from darkness to light; from death to immortality.

🕉 **Secular twin:** Say: ‘May I move from worry to trust, from darkness to light.’

Bṛhadāraṇyaka Upaniṣad 1.3.28

Fullness, kindness & a mother's song

Read the meaning first. Recite slowly, softly, without holding the breath.



Pūrṇamadaḥ — fullness

ॐ पूर्णमदः पूर्णमिदं पूर्णात्पूर्णमुदच्यते ।

पूर्णस्य पूर्णमादाय पूर्णमेवावशिष्यते ॥

om pūrṇam adaḥ pūrṇam idaṁ pūrṇāt pūrṇam udacyate |
pūrṇasya pūrṇam ādāya pūrṇam evāvaśiṣyate ॥

Meaning: That is whole; this is whole. From wholeness, wholeness comes forth. When wholeness is taken from wholeness, wholeness remains. — A beautiful image for a mother: a whole new life comes from you, and you remain whole.

🕉 **Secular twin:** Say: 'I am whole. You are whole. Love only grows.'

Bṛhadāraṇyaka Upaniṣad 5.1.1; Īśa Upaniṣad (invocation)

Sarve bhavantu sukhinaḥ — for all

सर्वे भवन्तु सुखिनः । सर्वे सन्तु निरामयाः ।

सर्वे भद्राणि पश्यन्तु । मा कश्चिदुःखभागभवेत् ॥

sarve bhavantu sukhinaḥ | sarve santu nirāmayāḥ |
sarve bhadrāṇi paśyantu | mā kaścid duḥkhabhāg bhavet ॥

Meaning: May all be happy; may all be free from illness; may all see what is good; may no one suffer.

🕉 **Secular twin:** Say: 'May everyone be happy and healthy.'

Traditional prayer (often attributed to the Upaniṣads; a close parallel appears in the Garuḍa Purāṇa) [needs verification]

Madālasā's lullaby

शुद्धोऽसि बुद्धोऽसि निरञ्जनोऽसि

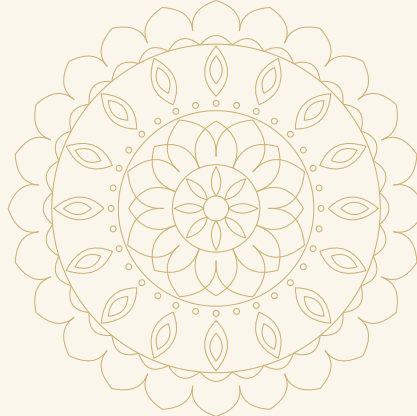
संसारमायापरिवर्जितोऽसि ।

śuddho 'si buddho 'si nirañjano 'si
saṁsāra-māyā-parivarjito 'si |

Meaning: You are pure, you are awake, you are spotless; you are untouched by the world's illusion. — Sung by Queen Madālasā to her infant sons in the Purāṇic story.

🕉 **Secular twin:** Sing: 'You are whole, you are good, you are loved.'

Mārkaṇḍeya Purāṇa (Madālasā episode); Madālasā Upadeśa tradition [wording needs verification]



Lullabies of India · I

Sing slowly, the same song again and again — familiarity is the gift.



Sanskrit

Original composition for this book

स्वपिहि वत्स स्वपिहि, चन्द्रो गगने हसति ।

माता त्वां पालयति, शान्तिः सर्वत्र भवतु ॥

svapihi vatsa svapihi, candro gagane hasati |
mātā tvāṃ pālayati, śāntiḥ sarvatra bhavatu ||

Meaning: Sleep, little one, sleep; the moon smiles in the sky. Mother watches over you; may there be peace everywhere.

Hindi

Original composition for this book

सो जा मेरे चंदा, सो जा मेरे लाल,

तारे गाएँ लोरी, हवा दे ताल।

माँ की बाँहों में सपनों का गाँव,

धीरे-धीरे आए निंदिया की छाँव।

so jā mere candā, so jā mere lāl,
tāre gāē lorī, havā de tāl.
mā kī bāhō mē sapnō kā gāv,
dhīre-dhīre āe nindiyā kī chāv.

Meaning: Sleep, my moon, sleep, my darling; the stars sing a lullaby, the breeze keeps time. In mother's arms is a village of dreams; slowly comes the shade of sleep.

Marathi

Original composition (aṅgāī) for this book

झोप रे बाळा झोप, चांदोबा आला अंगणी,

हळू हळू झुलतो पाळणा, गाते आई गाणी।

jhop re bālā jhop, cāndobā ālā aṅgaṇī,
haḷū haḷū jhulato pāḷaṇā, gāte āī gāṇī.

Meaning: Sleep, little one, sleep; Uncle Moon has come to the courtyard. Slowly the cradle swings; mother sings her songs.

Gujarati

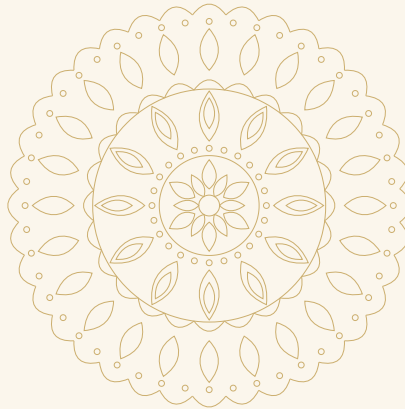
Original composition (hālārḍū) for this book

હાલા રે હાલા, સૂઈ જા મારા લાલ,

ચાંદામામા જુએ, તારલા ગાય ગીત.

hālā re hālā, sūī jā mārā lāl,
cāndāmāmā jue, tārālā gāya gīt.

Meaning: Hush-a-bye, hush-a-bye, sleep my darling; Uncle Moon is watching, the little stars sing a song.



● Singing to baby = familiar voice and melody (Partanen 2013). Lullabies are public domain, traditional refrains or original compositions written for this book. Native-script text should be checked by native speakers.

Lullabies of India · II

Sing slowly, the same song again and again — familiarity is the gift.



Tamil

Traditional tālāṭṭu refrain + original lines

ஆராரோ ஆரிரரோ, கண்ணே கண்மணியே கண்ணுறங்கு,
நிலா வந்து தாலாட்டும், நீ நிம்மதியாய் தூங்கு.

*ārārō ārirarō, kaṇṇē kaṇmaṇiyē kaṇṇuraṅku,
nilā vantu tālāṭṭum, nī nimmatiyāy tūṅku.*

Meaning: Aa-raa-ro, aa-ri-ra-ro (traditional refrain); my darling, apple of my eye, close your eyes; the moon will come and sing you a lullaby — sleep in peace.

Telugu

Annamācārya (1408–1503), public domain [wording needs verification]

జో అచ్యుతానంద జో జో ముకుంద,
రావె పరమానంద రామ గోవింద.

*jō acyutānanda jō jō mukunda,
rāve paramānanda rāma gōvinda.*

Meaning: Sleep, Achyuta, bliss; sleep, sleep, Mukunda; come, supreme joy, Rāma, Govinda. — A cradle song to the infant Krishna.

Kannada

Purandara Dāsa (1484–1564), public domain [wording needs verification]

ಜೋ ಜೋ ಶ್ರೀ ಕೃಷ್ಣ ಪರಮಾನಂದ,
ಜೋ ಜೋ ಗೋಪಿಯ ಕಂದ ಮುಕುಂದ.

*jō jō śrī kṛṣṇa paramānanda,
jō jō gōpiya kanda mukunda.*

Meaning: Sleep, sleep, Shri Krishna, supreme bliss; sleep, sleep, darling of the gopī, Mukunda.

Malayalam

Irayimman Thampi (1813), public domain

ഓമനത്തിങ്കൾ കിടാവോ, നല്ല
കോമളത്താമരപ്പൂവോ,
പൂവിൽ നിറഞ്ഞ മധുവോ, പരി-
പൂർണ്ണേന്ദു തന്റെ നിലാവോ.

*ōmanattinṅkaḷ kiṭāvō, nalla
kōmaḷattāmarappūvō,
pūvil niṛaṇṇa madhuvō, pari-
pūrṇēndu tanṇe nilāvō.*

Meaning: Are you the darling child of the moon, or a lovely tender lotus? The honey filling a flower, or the light of the full moon?

Bengali

Traditional chhaṛā, public domain [wording needs verification]

ঘুমপাড়ানি মাসি পিসি মোদের বাড়ি এসো,
খাট নেই পালঙ্ক নেই চোখ পেতে বোসো।

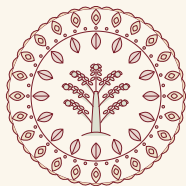
*ghumpāṛāni māsī pisi moder bāṛi eso,
khāṭ nei pālāṅka nei cokh pete boso.*

Meaning: Sleep-bringing auntsies, come to our house; there's no bed or cot — sit upon our eyes. (Calling sleep to come to the child.)

● Singing to baby = familiar voice and melody (Partanen 2013). Lullabies are public domain, traditional refrains or original compositions written for this book. Native-script text should be checked by native speakers.

Stories to read aloud · I

Original retellings to read aloud. Folk stories are labelled as such.



The Monkey and the Crocodile

Pañcatantra, Book 4 — retold for this book

On the bank of a wide river stood a rose-apple tree, and in it lived a cheerful monkey named Raktamukha. Every day a crocodile swam up to rest in the shade, and every day the monkey tossed him the sweetest, juiciest fruit. Soon they were the best of friends, talking until the sun went down.

The crocodile carried fruit home to his wife. 'If the fruit is this sweet,' she said, 'how sweet must be the heart of the monkey who eats it every day! Bring me his heart.' The crocodile was troubled, but he swam back and said, 'Friend, my wife wishes to thank you. Climb on my back and come to dinner.'

Halfway across the deep water, the crocodile confessed the truth. The monkey's heart thumped — but he kept his mind calm. 'Oh dear friend,' he said, 'why didn't you tell me? I keep my heart safe in the hollow of my tree! Take me back and I'll fetch it.'

The crocodile turned around. The moment they reached the bank, the monkey leapt high into his tree. 'A heart is not something you leave in a tree,' he called down kindly, 'and a friendship is not something you trade away.'

And so, little one, remember: a calm mind finds a way, even in deep water.



The Hare in the Moon

Śaśa Jātaka (Jātaka no. 316) — retold for this book

Long ago, in a forest by the mountains, four friends lived together: a monkey, a jackal, an otter and a gentle hare. The wise hare often said, 'Let us share what we have with anyone who is hungry.'

One full-moon evening, a tired old traveller came to rest beneath their tree. The otter brought him fish from the river. The jackal brought a pot of curd he had found. The monkey brought ripe mangoes from the treetops.

But the little hare ate only grass, and grass is no food for a traveller. 'I have nothing to give,' he thought, 'except myself.' So he gathered sticks, lit a small fire, and said, 'Friend, please accept me as your meal.' And he leapt towards the flames.

But the fire did not burn him — it felt as cool as snow. The traveller stood up and shone with light. He was Sakka, king of the gods, who had come to see who had the kindest heart. 'Your generosity should be remembered forever,' he said.

Then he drew the shape of the hare upon the face of the moon. Tonight, little one, when we look at the full moon, we will see the hare there still — a picture of a heart that gives.

Stories to read aloud · II

Original retellings to read aloud. Folk stories are labelled as such.



Rāma and the Squirrel

Folk tradition (South India); not found in Vālmīki's Rāmāyaṇa — retold for this book

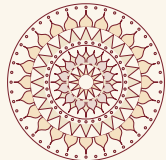
When Rāma's army built a bridge of stones across the ocean to Laṅkā, everyone helped. Mighty monkeys and bears lifted great boulders, and the sea rang with their work.

At the water's edge, a tiny squirrel was busy too. She rolled in the wet sand, ran onto the bridge, and shook the sand off between the stones. Back and forth, back and forth, all day long.

A big monkey laughed. 'Little one, what use is a few grains of sand when we carry mountains?'

Rāma saw it all. He lifted the squirrel gently in his palm. 'Every grain fills a gap that no boulder can,' he said. 'Her love is as great as yours.' He stroked her back with three fingers — and, the story says, that is why squirrels have three soft stripes to this day.

Little one, whatever you give with love — even something small — is never too little.



Hanumān's Leap

Vālmīki Rāmāyaṇa, Kiṣkindhā & Sundara Kāṇḍa — retold for this book

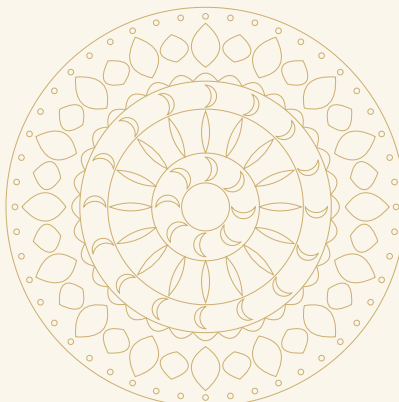
Sītā had been carried far across the ocean, and Rāma's friends stood on the shore, wondering who could cross the endless water. Each said, 'I can leap so far — but not that far.'

Hanumān sat quietly. He did not think he could do it either. Then the wise old bear Jāmbavān came and sat beside him. 'Hanumān,' he said, 'you have forgotten who you are. Your strength was always inside you. Remember it.'

Hanumān closed his eyes and breathed slowly. He remembered — and as he remembered, he grew taller and stronger, until he stood like a mountain on the shore.

With Rāma's name in his heart, he pressed his feet into the hill and leapt — over the waves, through the clouds, across the whole ocean — and landed safely on the other side.

Little one, there will be days when something feels too big. On those days, breathe slowly and remember: the strength you need is already inside you. (And your mother is learning this too.)



Nourish — food for two

Brain-supportive nutrients and where to find them in Indian kitchens

NUTRIENT	WHY IT MATTERS	VEGETARIAN SOURCES	NON-VEGETARIAN SOURCES
Folate	Forms the brain and spine early	Dals, rajma, chana, palak, methi, oranges, peanuts	Eggs, liver (small amounts)
Iron	Blood for two; baby's iron stores	Green leafy vegetables, bajra, ragi, poha, dates, halim (garden cress)	Meat, fish, eggs
Iodine	Thyroid and brain development	Iodised salt, milk, curd	Seafood, eggs
Choline	Brain and memory development	Soya, paneer, milk, peanuts, rajma, cauliflower	Eggs (richest), fish, chicken
Omega-3 / DHA	Brain and eyes; lowers early-birth risk	Walnuts, flaxseed, chia, mustard oil (ALA — ask about DHA)	Sardine, mackerel (bangda), rohu, pomfret
Protein	Growth of every tissue	Dals, sprouts (cooked), paneer, curd, soya, nuts	Eggs, fish, chicken
Calcium	Bones and teeth	Milk, curd, ragi, til, paneer, leafy greens	Small fish eaten with bones
Vitamin B12	Nerves and brain	Milk, curd, paneer; ask about a supplement	Eggs, fish, meat

Food safety

✓ Do

✓ Boiled or pasteurised milk and paneer

✓ Eggs, meat and fish fully cooked

✓ Wash fruit and vegetables in clean running water

✓ Refrigerate cooked food within 2 hours

✓ Take the iron, folic acid and calcium tablets your doctor prescribes — at separate times

✓ Under 200 mg caffeine a day

✗ Don't

✗ Alcohol or tobacco in any form (including gutka and second-hand smoke)

✗ Raw or half-boiled eggs, raw sprouts, raw milk

✗ High-mercury fish (shark, swordfish, king mackerel, big-eye tuna)

✗ Street food made with untreated water or ice

✗ Herbal medicines, kadhas, rasāyanas or supplements without your doctor

✗ Fasting or 'eating for two' — extra needs are modest (about 350 kcal a day from the 2nd trimester)

● Sources: ICMR-NIN 2020 & 2024; WHO 2016; Middleton 2018; Caudill 2018; FDA/EPA 2021; ACOG 2010. Quantities to be checked with your doctor or dietitian. ➕ Check with your doctor first.

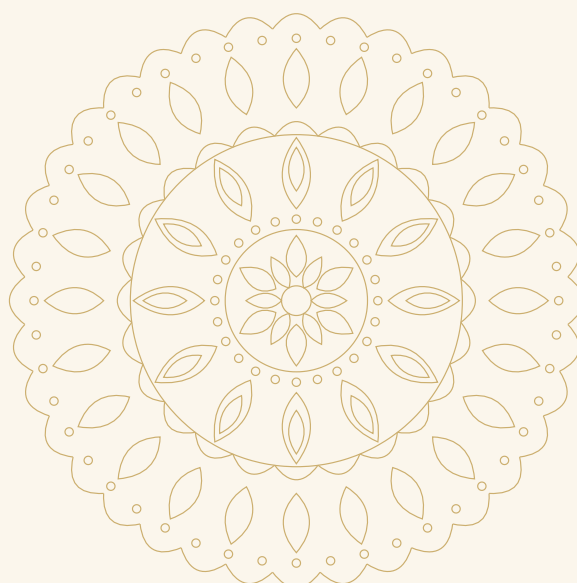
Traditional month-wise care

Māsānumāsika paricaryā — a summary of classical Ayurvedic texts

✦ This is a summary of historical texts. It is NOT medical or dietary advice. Your needs depend on your health — discuss any change in diet with your doctor.

MONTH	CLASSICAL RECOMMENDATION (CARAKA ŚĀ. 8/32, SUMMARISED)	NOTE FOR TODAY
1	Plain milk, as desired, with wholesome food	Boiled or pasteurised milk only
2	Milk prepared with sweet-category herbs	Herbs omitted — no herbal preparations
3	Milk with honey and ghee	Ghee in moderation
4	Butter from milk, or milk with butter	
5	Ghee prepared from milk	
6	Ghee prepared with sweet herbs	Herbs omitted
7	As in the sixth month	Herbs omitted
8	Rice gruel cooked in milk with ghee (kṣīra-yavāgū)	Like a light kheer or daliya (recipe in week 34)
9	Unctuous foods; medical procedures	Procedures are medical — not part of this book

The common thread: warm, gentle, nourishing food, easy to digest, with the mother's appetite and wishes respected. Suśruta (Śā. 10/4) and Vāgbhaṭa give similar month-wise lists. Modern guidance adds iron, folate, iodine, DHA and food safety — follow your doctor's advice.

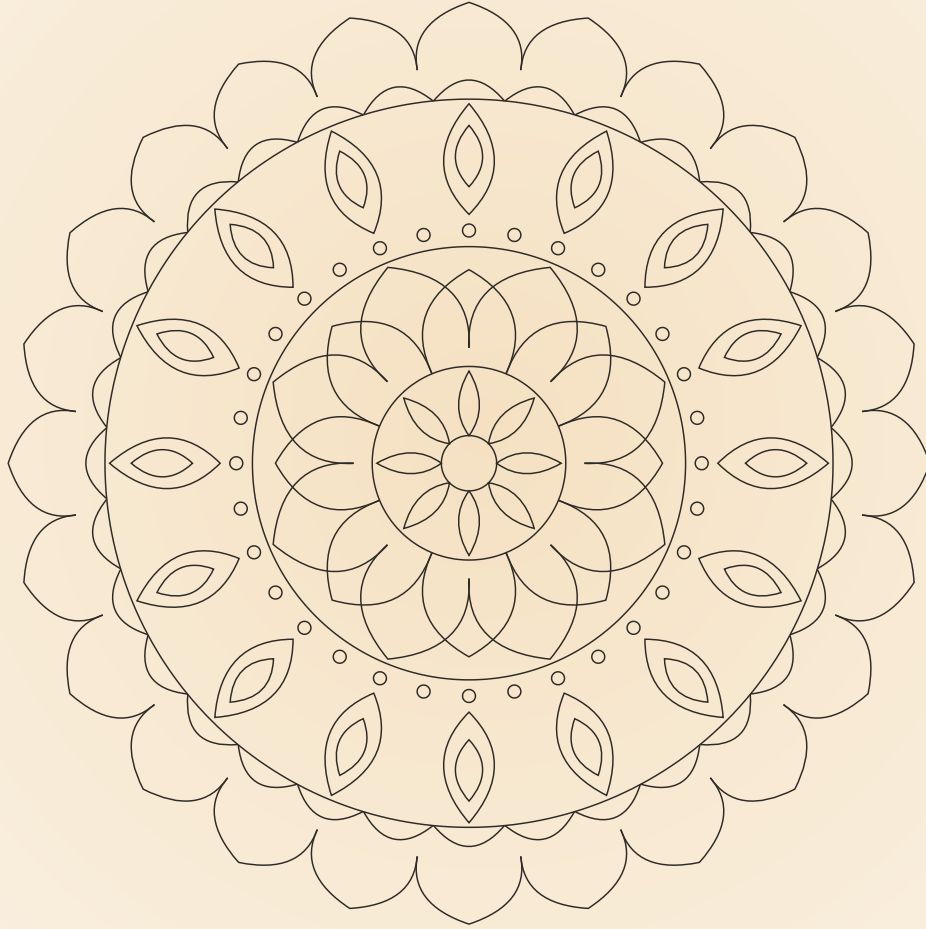


Bīja बीज

The Seed

A time of beginnings. Your body is doing enormous, invisible work. Rest, nourish, and be gentle with yourself — nausea and tiredness are signs of growth, not weakness.

- Folic acid and food safety
- Rest and gentle breathing
- Your first antenatal visits



स्थिरसुखमासनम्

sthira-sukham āsanam — Posture should be steady and comfortable. (Yoga Sūtra 2.46)
Colour the mandala slowly, one ring at a time. 🕒 Structured colouring may ease anxiety.

WEEKS

I–4

TRIMESTER 1

Sankalpa सङ्कल्प

Intention



about the size of a **poppy seed**
≈ 1 mm

Baby this week

Pregnancy is counted from your last period, so conception happens around the end of week 2. By week 4 a tiny ball of cells has nestled into the womb and is forming the layers that will become every organ.

HONEST NOTE

Most people don't know they are pregnant yet. Whenever you begin this book is the right time.

MIND

20 min

Calm music break

Make a calm playlist for the months ahead.

1. Choose soft music you enjoy (instrumental, bhajan, raga, lullaby).
2. Lie on your side or sit propped up.
3. Let your breath slow with the music.

🕒 Music lowered anxiety in pregnancy trials; effects are modest.

Safety: Keep volume comfortable; never place headphones on the belly.

BODY

5 min

Natural belly breathing

Learn belly breathing — your anchor for all 40 weeks.

1. Sit or lie on your side; hand on your belly.
2. Breathe in gently through the nose; feel the belly rise.
3. Breathe out a little longer than you breathe in (e.g., 4 in, 6 out).

🕒 Slow breathing is a well-established relaxation skill taught in antenatal classes.

⚠️ **Check with your doctor first. Safety:** Stop if dizzy, tingly or breathless. **Stop if:** pain, bleeding, dizziness, breathlessness, fluid leakage or contractions.

HEART

10 min

Letter to baby

What did you feel when you first found out?

🕒 Writing about feelings can ease stress; it also deepens connection.

SPIRIT

5 min

Five-layer check-in (Pañca Kośa)

Begin the five-layer check-in (page 13).



1. Body: what does it need? Breath: is it easy?
2. Mind: what am I feeling? Wisdom: what do I know?
3. Joy: what made me smile?

✦ The five sheaths of the Taittirīya Upaniṣad, used as a gentle self-care list.

NOURISH

Palak moong dal

Spinach and moong give folate, iron and protein.

Simple recipe: Cook ½ cup moong dal till soft. Add 2 cups chopped washed palak, a tempering of jeera, garlic and a pinch of haldi; simmer 5 min. Finish with lemon.

🕒 Folate foods

✓ Wash leafy greens well in running water.

✗ Don't skip prescribed folic acid tablets.

Folate helps form the baby's brain and spine. Take folic acid tablets as your doctor prescribes.

⚠️ **Check with your doctor first.**

WEEKLY CHECK-IN

MOOD



SLEEP (HRS/NIGHT)

WATER (GLASSES/DAY)



ENERGY



NAUSEA



PARTNER TASK

☐ Book the first antenatal appointment together.

ONE CALM MINUTE 🕒

Hand on belly. Whisper: 'Welcome.'

WEEK

5

TRIMESTER 1

Bīja बीज

The seed



about the size of a **sesame seed**
≈ 2 mm

Baby this week
The neural tube — the beginning of the brain and spinal cord — is forming and will close by the end of week 6. The first heart cells are gathering.

HONEST NOTE
This is why folic acid matters so much now: it greatly lowers the risk of neural-tube problems.

📖 MIND

🕒 5 min

A Śānti (peace) mantra

Asato mā — ‘lead me from darkness to light’ (page 20).

1. Choose Saha nāvavatu, Asato mā or Pūrṇamadaḥ (pages 20–21).

2. Recite slowly, ending with ‘śāntiḥ’ three times.

3. Rest your hands on your belly and feel the stillness.

🕒 Peace prayers from the Upaniṣads; calm comes mostly from slow, steady breath.

🧘 BODY

🕒 5 min

Natural belly breathing

Three slow breaths whenever nausea rises.

1. Sit or lie on your side; hand on your belly.

2. Breathe in gently through the nose; feel the belly rise.

3. Breathe out a little longer than you breathe in (e.g., 4 in, 6 out).

🕒 Slow breathing is a well-established relaxation skill taught in antenatal classes.

⚠️ Check with your doctor first. **Safety:** Stop if dizzy, tingly or breathless. **Stop if:** pain, bleeding, dizziness, breathlessness, fluid leakage or contractions.

💖 HEART

🕒 5 min

Worry to wish

What worry is on your mind? What wish is hiding inside it?

🕒 ‘When troubled by thoughts, cultivate the opposite’ — Yoga Sūtra 2.33.

🌸 SPIRIT

🕒 2 min

One calm minute

Notice 3 sounds around you.



1. Set a 1-minute timer.

2. Notice 3 sounds, 2 sensations, 1 breath.

3. Smile at baby before you get up.

🕒 Short mindfulness pauses; pregnancy research is encouraging but mixed.

🍽️ NOURISH

🕒 Small, frequent meals

Dry snacks & ginger

Small, frequent meals ease morning sickness.

Simple recipe: Keep roasted chana, khakhra or plain rusks by the bed. Eat a few before getting up. Sip water or warm water with a slice of fresh ginger through the day.

✓ Eat every 2–3 hours, small portions.

✗ Can't keep water down for a day? Call your doctor.

Eases nausea and heartburn.

⚠️ Check with your doctor first.

WEEKLY CHECK-IN

MOOD

☹️ ☹️ ☹️ 😊 😊

WATER (GLASSES/DAY)

UUUUUUUUUUUU

NAUSEA

○○○○○

PARTNER TASK

☐ Take over one daily chore so she can rest.

SLEEP (HRS/NIGHT)

ENERGY

○○○○○

ONE CALM MINUTE 🕒

Breathe in ‘I am’, breathe out ‘here’.

WEEK

6

TRIMESTER 1

Hrdaya हृदय

Heart



about the size of a **masoor lentil**
≈ 4 mm

Baby this week

A tiny heart begins to beat around now and may be seen on an early scan. The neural tube is closing.

HONEST NOTE

Suśruta wrote that the heart 'becomes manifest' in the 4th month; science now sees the first beats far earlier.

MIND

5 min

Soft Om chanting

Three soft Oms, morning and night.

1. Sit tall, shoulders soft. Breathe in through the nose.
2. Breathe out slowly: 'aaa-uuu-mmm', letting the 'mmm' hum.
3. Repeat 5–9 times; then sit quietly for a minute.

Slow, long exhalations are linked with calm; chanting studies are small.

Safety: No breath-holding; use a soft voice; stop if dizzy.

BODY

5 min

Neck & shoulder release

Release your neck and shoulders after screen time.

1. Sit tall. Slowly tilt the right ear to the right shoulder; 3 breaths.
2. Repeat on the left. Roll shoulders back 5 times.
3. Interlace fingers, stretch arms forward, round the upper back gently.

Gentle stretching fits safe-activity guidance.

Check with your doctor first. Safety: Move slowly; stop with pain or numbness. **Stop if:** pain, bleeding, dizziness, breathlessness, fluid leakage or contractions.

HEART

5 min

Three good things

Three good things from this week:

Gratitude exercises have small positive effects on wellbeing.

SPIRIT

2 min

Mudrā & breath

Try Jñāna mudrā (page 15).



1. Choose a mudrā from page 15.
2. Rest the hands on your thighs or belly.
3. Breathe slowly for 2 minutes.

Hand gestures from ritual, dance and meditation; healing claims are unproven.

NOURISH

Safe dairy

Unpasteurised milk and some soft cheeses can carry Listeria.

Simple recipe: Boil loose milk before use. Make paneer at home from boiled milk with lemon juice, or buy sealed, pasteurised paneer.

Food safety

✓ Refrigerate cooked food within 2 hours.

✗ No raw milk, raw eggs or undercooked meat.

Prevents infections that can harm pregnancy.

Check with your doctor first.

WEEKLY CHECK-IN

MOOD

SLEEP
(HRS/NIGHT)

WATER
(GLASSES/DAY)

ENERGY



NAUSEA



PARTNER TASK

☐ Keep water and a dry snack within her reach, always.

ONE CALM MINUTE

Feel your own heartbeat for one minute.

WEEK

7

TRIMESTER 1

Prāṇa प्राण

Breath of life



about the size of a jamun
≈ 1 cm

Baby this week

Arm and leg buds are lengthening and the brain is growing quickly. Your baby is now about the size of a jamun.

HONEST NOTE

Tiredness and nausea are common now. Rest is real work for two.

MIND

5 min

Talk to your baby

Tell baby one thing you love about your home.

1. Tell baby about your day — what you saw, smelled, ate.
2. Use baby's nickname.
3. Pause, breathe, and notice how you feel.

Your voice is the clearest sound in the womb; newborns prefer their mother's voice.

BODY

5 min

Bhrāmarī — humming bee

Five rounds of gentle humming before sleep.

1. Sit comfortably; close your eyes.
2. Breathe in through the nose; breathe out humming softly 'mmm'.
3. Optional: fingers lightly over the ears. 5–7 rounds.

Humming lengthens the out-breath; research is early and small.

Check with your doctor first. Safety: No breath-holding; don't press the ears; stop if dizzy. Stop if: pain, bleeding, dizziness, breathlessness, fluid leakage or contractions.

HEART

10 min

Letter to baby

What kind of parent do you hope to be?

Writing about feelings can ease stress; it also deepens connection.

SPIRIT

5 min

Lotus visualisation

Imagine one lotus petal opening.



1. Close your eyes; imagine a lotus on still water.
2. With each out-breath, one petal opens.
3. Rest in the open flower.

Guided imagery may ease anxiety; studies are small.

NOURISH

Jeera chaas & nimbu pani

Fluids help with constipation, swelling and urine infections.

Simple recipe: Chaas: whisk curd with water, roasted jeera, a pinch of salt and mint. Nimbu pani: lemon, water, a little jaggery, pinch of salt.

Water & fluids

✓ 8–10 glasses of fluid a day unless told otherwise.

✗ Limit sugary drinks and packaged juices.

Helps with constipation, swelling and urine infections.

Check with your doctor first.

WEEKLY CHECK-IN

MOOD



SLEEP (HRS/NIGHT)

WATER (GLASSES/DAY)



ENERGY



NAUSEA



PARTNER TASK

☐ Read the warning signs on page 8 together.

ONE CALM MINUTE

Long, slow out-breath — three times.

WEEK

8

TRIMESTER 1

Sparsa स्पर्श

Touch



about the size of a **rajma bean**
≈ 1.6 cm

Baby this week

Fingers are beginning to form. Around now the skin around the mouth starts to respond to touch — the first of the senses to wake.

HONEST NOTE

Touch is the earliest sense to develop; hearing and sight follow much later.

MIND

5 min

Wisdom line of the week

Read this week's wisdom line slowly, twice.

योगश्चित्तवृत्तिनिरोधः

yogaś citta-vṛtti-nirodhaḥ — Yoga is the settling of the mind's ripples. (Yoga Sūtra 1.2)

1. Read this week's line and its meaning.
2. Write it on a card and keep it where you can see it.
3. Return to it when the day feels heavy.

Contemplative reading from India's philosophical texts.

BODY

5 min

Pelvic-floor squeezes

Begin pelvic-floor squeezes — 3 times a day.

1. Gently squeeze as if stopping wind and urine; lift up and in.
2. Hold 3–5 seconds while breathing normally; release fully.
3. Repeat 8–10 times, 3 times a day.

Strong evidence: reduces leaking urine late in pregnancy and after birth.

Check with your doctor first. **Safety:** Don't practise while passing urine. Stop if painful. **Stop if:** pain, bleeding, dizziness, breathlessness, fluid leakage or contractions.

HEART

10 min

Reach out

Who can you share both joy and worry with this week?

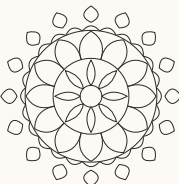
Support from others protects mothers' mental health.

SPIRIT

20 min

Mandala colouring

Colour the small mandala below.



1. Choose 2–3 calm colours.
2. Colour from the centre outwards, slowly.
3. Notice your breath as you work.

Structured colouring reduced anxiety in small studies.

NOURISH

Swap one cup

Too much caffeine is best avoided in pregnancy.

Simple recipe: Swap your second tea or coffee for warm haldi milk (from boiled milk), jeera water, or fresh coconut water.

Less caffeine

Under 200 mg caffeine a day ≈ 1 mug of coffee or 2–3 cups of tea.

Watch energy drinks and colas — they add up.

Keep caffeine under 200 mg a day.

Check with your doctor first.

WEEKLY CHECK-IN

MOOD



SLEEP (HRS/NIGHT)

WATER (GLASSES/DAY)



ENERGY



NAUSEA



PARTNER TASK

☐ Ask: what smell or food is bothering you? Then remove it.

ONE CALM MINUTE

Rest your hands together and feel their warmth.

WEEK

9

TRIMESTER 1

Śānti शान्ति

Peace



about the size of a **grape**
≈ 2.3 cm

Baby this week
All the main organs have begun to form. Baby makes tiny movements — far too small for you to feel yet.

HONEST NOTE
Feeling up and down is normal. If low mood lasts most days for two weeks, tell your doctor.

 MIND

5 min

A Śānti (peace) mantra

Saha nāvavatu — ‘may we two be protected together’ (page 20).

1. Choose Saha nāvavatu, Asato mā or Pūrṇamadaḥ (pages 20–21).

2. Recite slowly, ending with ‘śāntiḥ’ three times.

3. Rest your hands on your belly and feel the stillness.



Peace prayers from the Upaniṣads; calm comes mostly from slow, steady breath.

 BODY

10 min

Side-lying rest

A 10-minute side-lying rest after lunch.

1. Lie on your left or right side.

2. Pillow between the knees, one under the belly, one under the head.

3. Relax the jaw, hands and feet with each out-breath.



Side-lying avoids pressure on major blood vessels; relaxation lowers stress.



Check with your doctor first. Safety: After the first trimester, avoid lying flat on your back. **Stop if:** pain, bleeding, dizziness, breathlessness, fluid leakage or contractions.

 HEART

2 min

Belly-touch hello

What would you like to tell baby today?



In a small study, babies moved more when mothers touched their belly.



Safety: Gentle touch only.

 SPIRIT

10 min

Kolam on dots

Try the simple kolam on page 18.



1. Use the dot grid on page 18.

2. Draw one continuous line around the dots.

3. Let mistakes be part of the pattern.



Threshold art drawn at dawn across South India.

 NOURISH



Iodised salt

Iodised salt in home cooking

Iodine supports the baby’s thyroid and developing brain.

Simple recipe: Use iodised salt for everyday cooking and store it in a closed, dry jar away from the stove. Add salt towards the end of cooking.



Moderate amounts; ask your doctor if your BP is high.



Rock or sea salt usually lacks enough iodine for daily use.



Iodine is essential for the baby’s thyroid and brain.



Check with your doctor first.

WEEKLY CHECK-IN

MOOD



WATER (GLASSES/DAY)



NAUSEA



PARTNER TASK

☐ Plan a slow evening walk together.

SLEEP (HRS/NIGHT)

ENERGY



ONE CALM MINUTE 

Say ‘śānti’ silently on each out-breath.

WEEK

10

TRIMESTER 1

Mūla मूल

Root



about the size of a **ber**
(jujube)
≈ 3.1 cm

Baby this week

Baby is now called a fetus. The vital organs are in place and will spend the coming months growing and maturing.

HONEST NOTE

First-trimester tiredness is caused by real changes in your body. Resting is productive.

MIND

20 min

Calm music break

Ten minutes of music with your feet up.

1. Choose soft music you enjoy (instrumental, bhajan, raga, lullaby).
2. Lie on your side or sit propped up.
3. Let your breath slow with the music.

Music lowered anxiety in pregnancy trials; effects are modest.

Safety: Keep volume comfortable; never place headphones on the belly.

BODY

20 min

Daily walk

A 10–20 minute walk on most days.

1. Walk at a pace where you can still talk.
2. Build slowly towards 150 minutes a week.
3. Walk in cooler hours; carry water.

WHO and ACOG recommend regular moderate activity for most pregnancies.

Check with your doctor first. Safety: Stop with any warning sign (bleeding, pain, dizziness, fluid, contractions). **Stop if:** pain, bleeding, dizziness, breathlessness, fluid leakage or contractions.

HEART

10 min

Letter to baby

What would you like to tell your baby about your family's roots?

Writing about feelings can ease stress; it also deepens connection.

SPIRIT

5 min

Cakra check-in

Root (Mūlādhāra) check-in: what makes you feel safe?



1. Use the map on page 14.
2. Ask: where do I feel tense, warm, open?
3. Say the affirmation for that place.

A symbolic map from the tantric tradition — not anatomy or medicine.

NOURISH

Protein at every meal

Steamed sprout chaat

Sprouts are rich in protein, folate and fibre.

Simple recipe: Steam moong sprouts 5–7 min until soft. Toss with chopped cucumber, tomato, roasted jeera, lemon and coriander.

✓ Steam or cook sprouts.

✗ Avoid raw sprouts in pregnancy (germ risk).

Needs rise in the 2nd and 3rd trimesters.

Check with your doctor first.

WEEKLY CHECK-IN

MOOD



SLEEP
(HRS/NIGHT)

WATER
(GLASSES/DAY)



ENERGY



NAUSEA



PARTNER TASK

☐ Take charge of dinner twice this week.

ONE CALM MINUTE

Feel your feet on the floor. You are held.

WEEK

II

TRIMESTER 1

Svāda स्वाद

Taste



about the size of a **anjeer (fig)**
≈ 4.1 cm · ≈ 7 g

Baby this week
Taste buds are forming, and baby has begun swallowing small amounts of amniotic fluid.

HONEST NOTE
Flavours from your food later reach the amniotic fluid — a first ‘taste’ of home.

 MIND

5 min

Talk to your baby

Describe your favourite meal to baby.

1. Tell baby about your day — what you saw, smelled, ate.

2. Use baby’s nickname.

3. Pause, breathe, and notice how you feel.

Your voice is the clearest sound in the womb; newborns prefer their mother’s voice.

 BODY

5 min

Ankle circles & calf stretch

Ankle circles while you sit.

1. Seated: circle each ankle 10 times each way.

2. Standing at a wall: step one foot back, heel down, 3 breaths.

3. Swap legs.

Gentle movement for circulation and comfort.

⚠ Check with your doctor first. Safety: One-sided calf pain or swelling: call your doctor at once. Stop if: pain, bleeding, dizziness, breathlessness, fluid leakage or contractions.

 HEART

10 min

Partner task of the week

How has support felt this week? What would help more?

Practical and emotional support protects a mother’s wellbeing.

 SPIRIT

5 min

Kind wishes (maitrī)

Kind wishes for yourself and baby.



1. Silently wish: ‘May I be well. May my baby be well.’

2. Widen to family, friends, all beings.

3. Rest in the warmth.

Loving-kindness practice raises positive feelings; Yoga Sūtra 1.33.

 NOURISH

Tastes of home

Mixed vegetable sambar or dal

Varied home flavours reach the amniotic fluid; baby gets to ‘taste’ your family’s food.

Simple recipe: Cook toor dal with pumpkin, drumstick, carrot and beans. Add tamarind, sambar powder and a curry-leaf tempering. Eat with rice or idli.

✓ Eat a rainbow of seasonal vegetables.

✗ Avoid very spicy, oily food if you have heartburn.

Flavours reach the amniotic fluid; babies may later accept familiar tastes more easily.

⚠ Check with your doctor first.

WEEKLY CHECK-IN

MOOD



WATER (GLASSES/DAY)



NAUSEA



PARTNER TASK

☐ Make her comfort meal — the pregnancy-safe version.

SLEEP (HRS/NIGHT)



ENERGY



ONE CALM MINUTE

Taste one sip of water slowly.

Week 11 · Trimester 1 36

WEEK

12

TRIMESTER 1

Jala जल
Water



about the size of a **lime**
(nimbu)
≈ 5.4 cm · ≈ 14 g

Baby this week

Baby can open and close the fingers and curl the toes. The first-trimester screening scan often happens around 11–14 weeks.

HONEST NOTE

Write your questions for the scan on page 77 so you don't forget them.

MIND

20 min

Sound bath

A sound bath of water sounds — rain, river, waves.

1. Make a playlist on page 72: rain, birds, flute, veena.
2. Lie on your side with a pillow between your knees.
3. Listen without doing anything else.

Listening to calming sound can reduce anxiety; evidence is modest.

Safety: Comfortable volume only.

BODY

5 min

Cat–cow (Mārjārī)

Gentle cat–cow to ease the back.

1. On hands and knees; padding under the knees.
2. Breathe in: gently lift the chest and look ahead.
3. Breathe out: round the upper back softly. 6–8 rounds.

Among postures shown to be well tolerated in late pregnancy.

Check with your doctor first. Safety: Keep the movement small; no deep sagging of the back. Stop with pain. **Stop if:** pain, bleeding, dizziness, breathlessness, fluid leakage or contractions.

HEART

5 min

Worry to wish

What are you hoping to hear at the scan?

'When troubled by thoughts, cultivate the opposite' — Yoga Sūtra 2.33.

SPIRIT

2 min

One calm minute

One calm minute before the scan.



1. Set a 1-minute timer.
2. Notice 3 sounds, 2 sensations, 1 breath.
3. Smile at baby before you get up.

Short mindfulness pauses; pregnancy research is encouraging but mixed.

NOURISH

Ragi dosa with tomato chutney

Ragi gives iron and calcium; tomato's vitamin C helps absorb iron.

Simple recipe: Mix 1 cup ragi flour, ¼ cup rice flour, curd and water to a thin batter with onion and coriander. Cook thin dosas. Serve with fresh tomato chutney.

Iron + vitamin C

✓ Pair iron foods with amla, lemon, guava or tomato.

✗ Avoid tea or coffee within an hour of meals.

Iron builds blood for two; vitamin C helps absorb it.

Check with your doctor first.

WEEKLY CHECK-IN

MOOD



SLEEP
(HRS/NIGHT)

WATER
(GLASSES/DAY)



ENERGY



NAUSEA



PARTNER TASK

☐ Come to the scan, and ask your own questions too.

ONE CALM MINUTE

Imagine a still pond. Breathe.

WEEK

13

TRIMESTER 1

Pallava पल्लव
New leaf



about the size of a **pea pod**
≈ 7.4 cm · ≈ 23 g

Baby this week

The first trimester ends this week. Fingerprints are beginning to form and the vocal cords are developing.

HONEST NOTE

The risk of miscarriage falls considerably after the first trimester.

MIND

5 min

Wisdom line of the week

Read this week's wisdom line; keep it on a card.

अभ्यासवैराग्याभ्यां तन्निरोधः

abhyāsa-vairāgyābhyāṃ tan-nirodhaḥ — Steady practice and gentle letting go calm the mind. (Yoga Sūtra 1.12)

1. Read this week's line and its meaning.
2. Write it on a card and keep it where you can see it.
3. Return to it when the day feels heavy.

Contemplative reading from India's philosophical texts.

BODY

5 min

Neck & shoulder release

Stretch your neck and shoulders, slowly.

1. Sit tall. Slowly tilt the right ear to the right shoulder; 3 breaths.
2. Repeat on the left. Roll shoulders back 5 times.
3. Interlace fingers, stretch arms forward, round the upper back gently.

Gentle stretching fits safe-activity guidance.

Check with your doctor first. **Safety:** Move slowly; stop with pain or numbness. **Stop if:** pain, bleeding, dizziness, breathlessness, fluid leakage or contractions.

HEART

10 min

Letter to baby

A letter to close the first trimester:

Writing about feelings can ease stress; it also deepens connection.

SPIRIT

2 min

Mudrā & breath

Try Dhyāna mudrā (page 15).



1. Choose a mudrā from page 15.
2. Rest the hands on your thighs or belly.
3. Breathe slowly for 2 minutes.

Hand gestures from ritual, dance and meditation; healing claims are unproven.

NOURISH

Curd rice with til tempering

Curd and sesame give calcium for bones and teeth.

Simple recipe: Mix soft rice with fresh curd and a little milk. Temper with mustard seeds, curry leaves and a spoon of til. Add grated carrot.

Calcium foods

- ✓ Set curd from boiled or pasteurised milk.
- ✗ Don't take calcium and iron tablets together — space them out.

For baby's bones and teeth, and your own.

Check with your doctor first.

WEEKLY CHECK-IN

MOOD



SLEEP (HRS/NIGHT)

WATER (GLASSES/DAY)



ENERGY



NAUSEA



PARTNER TASK

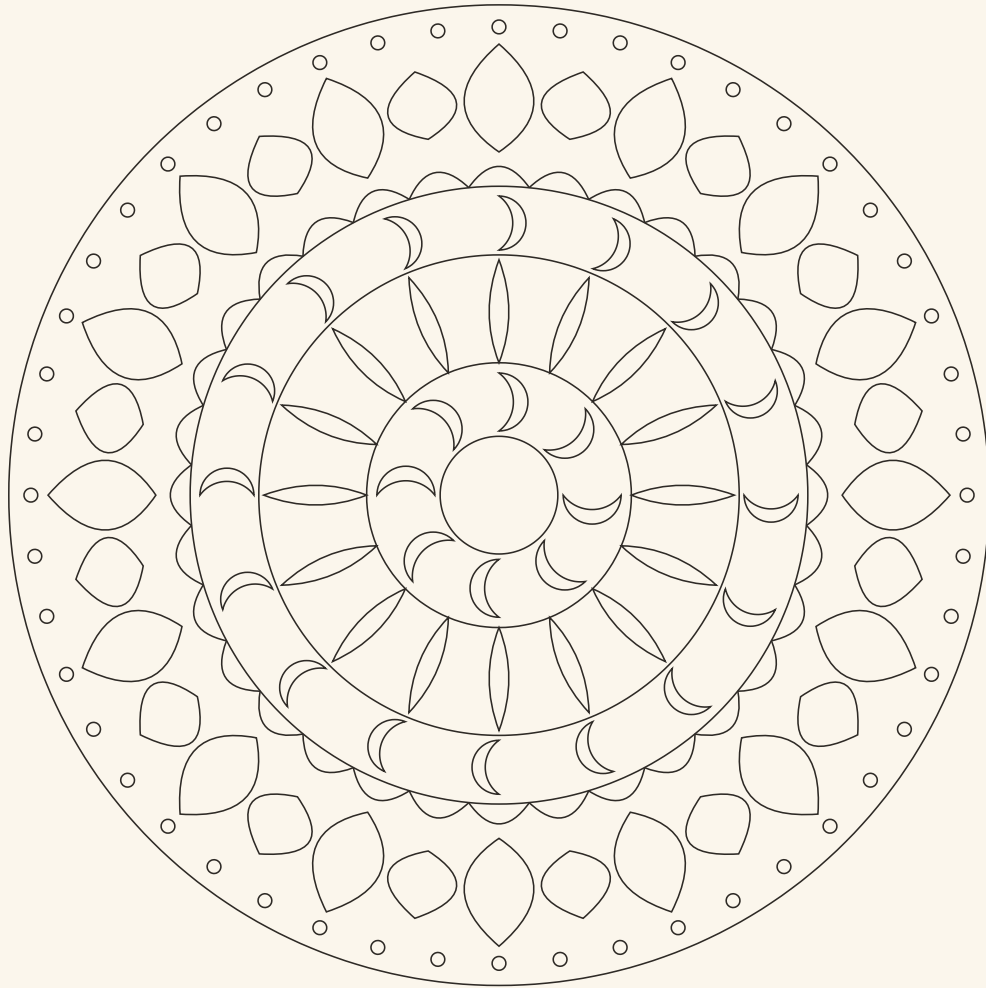
☐ Celebrate the end of the first trimester with something she enjoys.

ONE CALM MINUTE

Thank your body for these 13 weeks.

Moon mandala

Candra — the cool, calm light. Colour slowly; let each ring be one breath.



Trimester 1 — reflection

What surprised me this trimester

What I am proud of

What I want to carry into the next weeks

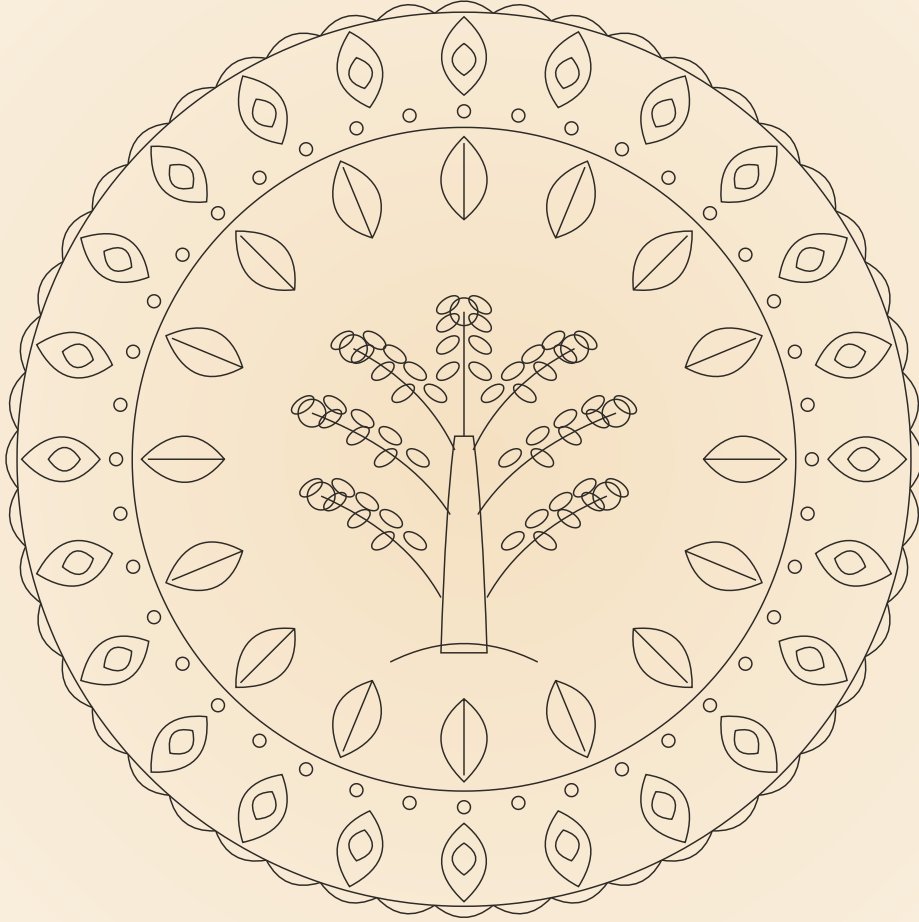
TRIMESTER 2 · WEEKS 14-27

Aṅkura अङ्कुर

The Sprout

Often the most comfortable trimester. Baby begins to hear around 19 weeks, and you may feel the first flutters. Your voice becomes part of baby's world.

- Talking, reading and singing to baby
- Gentle movement, most days
- The anomaly and sugar tests



मैत्रीकरुणामुदितोपेक्षाणां ... चित्तप्रसादनम्

maitrī-karuṇā-muditopekṣāṇāṃ ... citta-prasādanam — Friendliness, compassion, gladness and equanimity make the mind clear and serene. (Yoga Sūtra 1.33)

Colour the mandala slowly, one ring at a time. 🕒 Structured colouring may ease anxiety.

WEEK

14

TRIMESTER 2

Utsāha उत्साह

Renewed energy



about the size of a **lemon**
≈ 8.7 cm · ≈ 43 g

Baby this week

Baby moves arms and legs, and can squint and make faces.
Many mothers feel more energy now.

HONEST NOTE

Use the energy for gentle activity — and keep resting when you need to.

MIND

10 min

Indian story time

Read *'The Monkey and the Crocodile'* (page 24).

1. Read one of the stories on pages 24–25 aloud.
2. Use different voices for the characters.
3. Talk about the story's kindness or courage.

● Reading aloud = your voice for baby. The story's values are for the family to share.

BODY

20 min

Daily walk

Build up to 20–30 minute walks.

1. Walk at a pace where you can still talk.
2. Build slowly towards 150 minutes a week.
3. Walk in cooler hours; carry water.

● WHO and ACOG recommend regular moderate activity for most pregnancies.

⚠ **Check with your doctor first. Safety:** Stop with any warning sign (bleeding, pain, dizziness, fluid, contractions). **Stop if:** pain, bleeding, dizziness, breathlessness, fluid leakage or contractions.

HEART

5 min

Three good things

Three good things from this week:

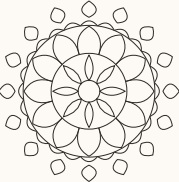
🕒 Gratitude exercises have small positive effects on wellbeing.

SPIRIT

20 min

Mandala colouring

Colour the small mandala below.



1. Choose 2–3 calm colours.
2. Colour from the centre outwards, slowly.
3. Notice your breath as you work.

🕒 Structured colouring reduced anxiety in small studies.

NOURISH

Mackerel (bangda) or sardine curry / walnut-flax ladoo

Omega-3 fats build the brain and eyes and lower the risk of early birth.

Simple recipe: Fish: cook bangda or sardine in a tomato-coconut curry until flaky. Vegetarian: blend dates, walnuts and roasted flaxseed; roll small ladoos.

● Omega-3 fats

✓ Low-mercury fish 2–3 times a week; ask about DHA if vegetarian.

✗ Avoid shark, swordfish, king mackerel (surmai — check locally) and big-eye tuna.

Omega-3 fats lower the risk of early birth and build brain and eyes.

⚠ **Check with your doctor first.**

WEEKLY CHECK-IN

MOOD



SLEEP
(HRS/NIGHT)

WATER
(GLASSES/DAY)



ENERGY



BABY'S PATTERN

☐ felt flutters / movement

PARTNER TASK

☐ Plan a gentle outing together.

ONE CALM MINUTE 🕒

Smile, and feel the smile in your belly.

WEEK

15

TRIMESTER 2

Puṣṭi पुष्टि

Nourishment



about the size of a **apple**
≈ 10.1 cm · ≈ 70 g

Baby this week
Bones are hardening and the ears are moving into their final position.

HONEST NOTE
From around 19 weeks baby begins to respond to sound — start choosing your songs.

📖 MIND

5 min

Lullaby in your mother tongue

Choose a lullaby in your mother tongue (pages 22–23).

1. Choose a lullaby in your home language (pages 22–23).

2. Ask an elder how they sang it.

3. Sing it to baby — the melody of your language is a welcome.

● Newborns are already tuned to the sound patterns of the language they heard in the womb.

🧘 BODY

5 min

Mountain & side stretch

Mountain pose and side stretch.

1. Stand feet hip-width; chair beside you.

2. Breathe in, raise one arm; breathe out, lean gently to the side.

3. 3 breaths each side.

● Standing stretches were well tolerated in studies.

⚠️ Check with your doctor first. Safety:

Hold a chair if unsteady. Stop if dizzy. Stop if: pain, bleeding, dizziness, breathlessness, fluid leakage or contractions.

💖 HEART

5 min

Imagine meeting baby

Picture baby's face. What do you imagine?

💡 Thinking about baby is linked with bonding after birth.

🕸 SPIRIT

10 min

Kolam on dots

Draw a kolam with three loops.



1. Use the dot grid on page 18.

2. Draw one continuous line around the dots.

3. Let mistakes be part of the pattern.

✦ Threshold art drawn at dawn across South India.

🍽 NOURISH

● Choline foods

Egg bhurji or soya-paneer bhurji

Eggs are the richest everyday source of choline; soya and paneer help vegetarians.

Simple recipe: Sauté onion, tomato, haldi and jeera. Add 2 beaten eggs (or crumbled paneer + soaked soya granules). Cook until fully firm. Eat with a roti and salad.

✓ Cook eggs until yolk and white are firm.

✗ No half-boiled or raw eggs (including in homemade mayonnaise).

Choline supports brain development; a small trial found benefits from higher intake.

⚠️ Check with your doctor first.

WEEKLY CHECK-IN

MOOD

☹ ☹ ☹ ☹ ☹

WATER (GLASSES/DAY)

UUUUUUUUUUUU

BABY'S PATTERN

☐ felt flutters / movement

SLEEP (HRS/NIGHT)

PARTNER TASK

☐ Find out about antenatal classes near you.

ENERGY

OOOOOO

ONE CALM MINUTE 🕒

Breathe in nourishment, breathe out thanks.

Week 15 · Trimester 2 42

WEEK

16

TRIMESTER 2

Spanda स्पन्द

Flutter



about the size of a **chikoo**
≈ 11.6 cm · ≈ 100 g

Baby this week

You may soon feel the first flutters — usually between 16 and 24 weeks, often later in a first pregnancy.

HONEST NOTE

Not feeling movement yet at 16 weeks is normal. Patterns become clearer after 24 weeks.

MIND

5 min

Sing a lullaby

Sing your chosen lullaby every evening.

1. Choose one lullaby (pages 22–23) or a family favourite.
2. Sing softly, as many times as you like.
3. Keep the same song for the coming weeks.

● Newborns show memory for sounds heard before birth; singing may also help bonding.

BODY

5 min

Cat–cow (Mārjārī)

Cat–cow, 6–8 slow rounds.

1. On hands and knees; padding under the knees.
2. Breathe in: gently lift the chest and look ahead.
3. Breathe out: round the upper back softly. 6–8 rounds.

● Among postures shown to be well tolerated in late pregnancy.

⊕ **Check with your doctor first. Safety:** Keep the movement small; no deep sagging of the back. Stop with pain. **Stop if:** pain, bleeding, dizziness, breathlessness, fluid leakage or contractions.

HEART

2 min

Belly-touch hello

Hands on belly: what do you feel?

● In a small study, babies moved more when mothers touched their belly.

Safety: Gentle touch only.

SPIRIT

5 min

Lotus visualisation

Lotus visualisation before sleep.



1. Close your eyes; imagine a lotus on still water.
2. With each out-breath, one petal opens.
3. Rest in the open flower.

● Guided imagery may ease anxiety; studies are small.

NOURISH

● Vitamin B12

Paneer–peas paratha with curd

Dairy gives vitamin B12, protein and calcium to vegetarians.

Simple recipe: Stuff whole-wheat dough with mashed paneer, peas, coriander and jeera. Cook on a tawa with a little ghee. Serve with curd.

✓ Ask your doctor about a B12 check if you are vegetarian.

✗ Don't self-prescribe supplements.

Important for the nervous system; vegetarians can run low.

⊕ **Check with your doctor first.**

WEEKLY CHECK-IN

MOOD



SLEEP
(HRS/NIGHT)

WATER
(GLASSES/DAY)



ENERGY



BABY'S PATTERN

☐ felt flutters / movement

PARTNER TASK

☐ Rest a hand on the bump each evening — flutters come soon.

ONE CALM MINUTE ●

Notice the smallest sensation in your body.

WEEK

17

TRIMESTER 2

Smṛti स्मृति

Memory



about the size of a
pomegranate
≈ 13 cm · ≈ 140 g

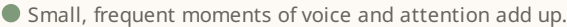
Baby this week
Fat begins to form under the skin and the umbilical cord grows stronger.

HONEST NOTE
Making memories now — photos, recordings, letters — becomes a gift for your child later.

 **MIND** 2 min

Baby-talk moment
Say hello to baby three times today.

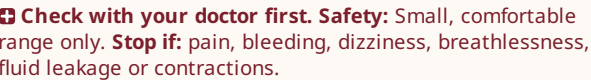
- Say hello to baby by name.
- Describe what you are doing right now.
- Say: 'I am here. I love you.'



 **BODY** 5 min

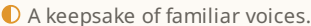
Wall pelvic tilts
Wall pelvic tilts for the lower back.

- Stand with your back against a wall, knees soft.
- Breathe out: gently press the low back towards the wall.
- Breathe in: release. 8–10 times.

 **HEART** 10 min

Record a voice message
Record your first voice message. What did you say?

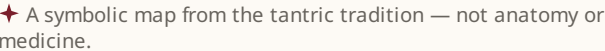


 **SPIRIT** 5 min

Cakra check-in
Sacral (Svādhiṣṭhāna) check-in: what brings you joy?

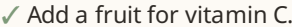


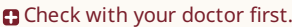
- Use the map on page 14.
- Ask: where do I feel tense, warm, open?
- Say the affirmation for that place.



 **NOURISH** Protein at every meal

Vegetable poha with peanuts
Poha (with lemon) gives iron; peanuts add protein and choline; vegetables add fibre.
Simple recipe: Rinse thick poha. Sauté mustard, curry leaves, onion, peas and carrot; add haldi, poha and roasted peanuts. Finish with lemon and coriander.



Needs rise in the 2nd and 3rd trimesters.


WEEKLY CHECK-IN

MOOD



WATER (GLASSES/DAY)

BABY'S PATTERN

☐ felt flutters / movement

PARTNER TASK

☐ Record a voice message for baby (page 73).

SLEEP (HRS/NIGHT)

ENERGY

ONE CALM MINUTE 

Remember a happy childhood moment.

Week 17 · Trimester 2 44

WEEK

18

TRIMESTER 2

Gita गीत

Song



about the size of a **sweet potato**
≈ 14.2 cm · ≈ 190 g

Baby this week

The structures of the inner ear are developing fast. Very soon baby will begin to respond to sound.

HONEST NOTE

Low sounds — like voices and humming — pass through the womb most easily.

MIND

5 min

Sing a lullaby

Choose ONE family song to sing all pregnancy.

1. Choose one lullaby (pages 22–23) or a family favourite.
2. Sing softly, as many times as you like.
3. Keep the same song for the coming weeks.

Newborns show memory for sounds heard before birth; singing may also help bonding.

BODY

5 min

Bhrāmarī — humming bee

Humming bee breath, 5 rounds.

1. Sit comfortably; close your eyes.
2. Breathe in through the nose; breathe out humming softly ‘mmm’.
3. Optional: fingers lightly over the ears. 5–7 rounds.

Humming lengthens the out-breath; research is early and small.

Check with your doctor first. **Safety:** No breath-holding; don't press the ears; stop if dizzy. **Stop if:** pain, bleeding, dizziness, breathlessness, fluid leakage or contractions.

HEART

5 min

Partner's voice for baby

How did baby's other parent feel talking to the bump?

Babies hear voices outside the womb from mid-pregnancy.

SPIRIT

2 min

One calm minute

Listen to silence for one minute.



1. Set a 1-minute timer.
2. Notice 3 sounds, 2 sensations, 1 breath.
3. Smile at baby before you get up.

Short mindfulness pauses; pregnancy research is encouraging but mixed.

NOURISH

Folate foods

Palak moong dal

Spinach and moong give folate, iron and protein.

Simple recipe: Cook ½ cup moong dal till soft. Add 2 cups chopped washed palak, a tempering of jeera, garlic and a pinch of haldi; simmer 5 min. Finish with lemon.

- ✓ Wash leafy greens well in running water.
- ✗ Don't skip prescribed folic acid tablets.

Folate helps form the baby's brain and spine. Take folic acid tablets as your doctor prescribes.

Check with your doctor first.

WEEKLY CHECK-IN

MOOD



SLEEP (HRS/NIGHT)

WATER (GLASSES/DAY)



ENERGY



BABY'S PATTERN

☐ felt flutters / movement

PARTNER TASK

☐ Choose the family lullaby together.

ONE CALM MINUTE

Hum one note until the breath is gently done.

WEEK

19

TRIMESTER 2

Śruti श्रुति
Hearing



about the size of a **mango**
≈ 15.3 cm · ≈ 240 g

Baby this week

In research, the first responses to sound appear at around 19 weeks — starting with low tones.

HONEST NOTE

Science-backed: babies hear in the womb and come to know familiar voices. It does not make a baby 'smarter' — it builds familiarity.

MIND

5 min

Talk to your baby

Talk to baby every day from today.

1. Tell baby about your day — what you saw, smelled, ate.
2. Use baby's nickname.
3. Pause, breathe, and notice how you feel.

● Your voice is the clearest sound in the womb; newborns prefer their mother's voice.

BODY

5 min

Anulom vilom — no holding

Alternate-nostril breathing — never hold the breath.

1. Right thumb rests by the right nostril, ring finger by the left.
2. Breathe in left, out right; in right, out left — slowly.
3. No pausing or holding the breath. 5–9 rounds.

● Gentle yogic breathing; small studies suggest calming effects.

⚠ **Check with your doctor first. Safety:** Never hold the breath. Skip if your nose is blocked. Stop if dizzy. **Stop if:** pain, bleeding, dizziness, breathlessness, fluid leakage or contractions.

HEART

5 min

Partner's voice for baby

What did you tell baby today?

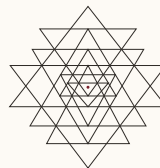
● Babies hear voices outside the womb from mid-pregnancy.

SPIRIT

3 min

Soft gaze at a yantra

Soft gaze at the Śrī Yantra (page 17).



1. Place the yantra (page 17) at eye level, arm's length.
2. Look softly at the centre dot (bindu); blink freely.
3. Close your eyes and rest. 1–3 minutes.

✦ A contemplative heritage practice — not a medical treatment.

Safety: Blink normally; stop if your eyes strain or water.

NOURISH

Ragi dosa with tomato chutney

Ragi gives iron and calcium; tomato's vitamin C helps absorb iron.

Simple recipe: Mix 1 cup ragi flour, ¼ cup rice flour, curd and water to a thin batter with onion and coriander. Cook thin dosas. Serve with fresh tomato chutney.

● Iron + vitamin C

✓ Pair iron foods with amla, lemon, guava or tomato.

✗ Avoid tea or coffee within an hour of meals.

Iron builds blood for two; vitamin C helps absorb it.

⚠ **Check with your doctor first.**

WEEKLY CHECK-IN

MOOD



SLEEP
(HRS/NIGHT)

WATER
(GLASSES/DAY)



ENERGY



BABY'S PATTERN

☐ felt flutters / movement

PARTNER TASK

☐ Talk to the bump for 5 minutes each evening.

ONE CALM MINUTE ●

Listen to your own breath.

WEEK

20

TRIMESTER 2

Madhya मध्य

Halfway



about the size of a **banana**
≈ 25.6 cm · ≈ 300 g

Baby this week

Halfway! A protective coating (vernix) covers the skin. The detailed anomaly scan usually happens at 18–22 weeks. (From now, length is measured head to heel.)

HONEST NOTE

Every pregnancy grows at its own pace; sizes here are averages.

MIND

10 min

Indian story time

Read *'The Hare in the Moon'* (page 24).

1. Read one of the stories on pages 24–25 aloud.
2. Use different voices for the characters.
3. Talk about the story's kindness or courage.

● Reading aloud = your voice for baby. The story's values are for the family to share.

BODY

20 min

Daily walk

A walk where you can still talk comfortably.

1. Walk at a pace where you can still talk.
2. Build slowly towards 150 minutes a week.
3. Walk in cooler hours; carry water.

● WHO and ACOG recommend regular moderate activity for most pregnancies.

✚ **Check with your doctor first. Safety:** Stop with any warning sign (bleeding, pain, dizziness, fluid, contractions). **Stop if:** pain, bleeding, dizziness, breathlessness, fluid leakage or contractions.

HEART

10 min

Letter to baby

A letter at the halfway point:

● Writing about feelings can ease stress; it also deepens connection.

SPIRIT

20 min

Trace the Śrī Yantra

Trace the Śrī Yantra (page 17).



1. Trace the nine triangles slowly with a pencil.
2. Colour the petals, starting from the outside.
3. End by resting your gaze at the centre.

✚ Sacred geometry of the Śrī Vidyā tradition; shared as heritage art.

NOURISH

Steamed sprout chaat

Sprouts are rich in protein, folate and fibre.

Simple recipe: Steam moong sprouts 5–7 min until soft. Toss with chopped cucumber, tomato, roasted jeera, lemon and coriander.

● Protein at every meal

✓ Steam or cook sprouts.

✗ Avoid raw sprouts in pregnancy (germ risk).

Needs rise in the 2nd and 3rd trimesters.

✚ Check with your doctor first.

WEEKLY CHECK-IN

MOOD



WATER
(GLASSES/DAY)



BABY'S PATTERN

☐ felt flutters / movement

PARTNER TASK

☐ Go with her to the anomaly scan.

SLEEP
(HRS/NIGHT)

ENERGY



ONE CALM MINUTE

Halfway. Breathe in what has been; breathe out what will be.

WEEK

21

TRIMESTER 2

Gati गति

Movement



about the size of a carrot
≈ 26.7 cm · ≈ 360 g

Baby this week
Movements grow stronger. You may notice times of day when baby is more active.

HONEST NOTE
Start noticing your baby's own pattern — there is no 'right' number of kicks.

 MIND

2 min

Baby-talk moment

Tell baby what you are doing as you do it.

1. Say hello to baby by name.

2. Describe what you are doing right now.

3. Say: 'I am here. I love you.'

● Small, frequent moments of voice and attention add up.

 BODY

5 min

Gentle warrior II

Gentle warrior II with a chair nearby.

1. Wide, comfortable stance; front knee over the ankle.

2. Arms out to the sides; gaze over the front hand.

3. 3 breaths; swap. Keep a chair nearby.

● Well tolerated in a study of 26 postures.

⊕ Check with your doctor first. Safety:

Short stance, no strain; stop with pelvic pain. Stop if: pain, bleeding, dizziness, breathlessness, fluid leakage or contractions.

 HEART

5 min

Three good things

Three good things from this week:

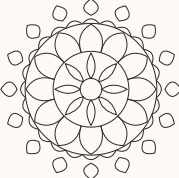
● Gratitude exercises have small positive effects on wellbeing.

 SPIRIT

20 min

Mandala colouring

Colour the small mandala below.



1. Choose 2–3 calm colours.

2. Colour from the centre outwards, slowly.

3. Notice your breath as you work.

● Structured colouring reduced anxiety in small studies.

 NOURISH

Water & fluids

Jeera chaas & nimbu pani

Fluids help with constipation, swelling and urine infections.

Simple recipe:

Chaas: whisk curd with water, roasted jeera, a pinch of salt and mint. Nimbu pani: lemon, water, a little jaggery, pinch of salt.

✓ 8–10 glasses of fluid a day unless told otherwise.

✗ Limit sugary drinks and packaged juices.

Helps with constipation, swelling and urine infections.

⊕ Check with your doctor first.

WEEKLY CHECK-IN

MOOD



WATER (GLASSES/DAY)

BABY'S PATTERN

☐ felt flutters / movement

PARTNER TASK

☐ Feel for kicks with your hand on the bump.

SLEEP (HRS/NIGHT)

ENERGY

ONE CALM MINUTE ●

Wait for a kick. Breathe until it comes.

WEEK

22

TRIMESTER 2

Rūpa रूप

Form



about the size of a **ridge gourd**
≈ 27.8 cm • ≈ 430 g

Baby this week

Lips, eyelids and eyebrows are more distinct. Baby's grip is getting stronger.

HONEST NOTE

Looks are shaped by genes, not by what you see or do — let go of any such worry.

MIND

5 min

Lullaby in your mother tongue

Ask an elder to teach you a lullaby.

1. Choose a lullaby in your home language (pages 22–23).
2. Ask an elder how they sang it.
3. Sing it to baby — the melody of your language is a welcome.

● Newborns are already tuned to the sound patterns of the language they heard in the womb.

BODY

5 min

Supported butterfly

Supported butterfly on a cushion.

1. Sit on a folded blanket; soles of feet together.
2. Cushions under the knees; spine tall.
3. Breathe slowly for 1–2 minutes. No bouncing.

● A common, gentle hip-opener in prenatal yoga programmes.

⊕ **Check with your doctor first. Safety:** Skip if you have pelvic (pubic) pain. **Stop if:** pain, bleeding, dizziness, breathlessness, fluid leakage or contractions.

HEART

5 min

Imagine meeting baby

Imagine holding baby's hand. What do you feel?

● Thinking about baby is linked with bonding after birth.

SPIRIT

2 min

Mudrā & breath

Try Prāṇa mudrā (page 15).



1. Choose a mudrā from page 15.
2. Rest the hands on your thighs or belly.
3. Breathe slowly for 2 minutes.

✦ Hand gestures from ritual, dance and meditation; healing claims are unproven.

NOURISH

● Vitamin B12

Paneer–peas paratha with curd

Dairy gives vitamin B12, protein and calcium to vegetarians.

Simple recipe: Stuff whole-wheat dough with mashed paneer, peas, coriander and jeera. Cook on a tawa with a little ghee. Serve with curd.

✓ Ask your doctor about a B12 check if you are vegetarian.

✗ Don't self-prescribe supplements.

Important for the nervous system; vegetarians can run low.

⊕ **Check with your doctor first.**

WEEKLY CHECK-IN

MOOD

SLEEP
(HRS/NIGHT)

WATER
(GLASSES/DAY)

ENERGY



BABY'S PATTERN

☐ felt flutters / movement

PARTNER TASK

☐ Start the family tree with the elders (page 74).

ONE CALM MINUTE ●

Open and close your hands slowly.

WEEK

23

TRIMESTER 2

Dhvani ध्वनि

Sound

about the size of a **mooli (radish)**
≈ 28.9 cm · ≈ 500 g

Baby this week
Hearing is maturing; loud sudden sounds may make baby startle or move.

HONEST NOTE
Keep music at a comfortable volume — never place headphones on the belly.

📖 MIND

🕒 20 min

Calm music break

Music with your feet up, 20 minutes.

1. Choose soft music you enjoy (instrumental, bhajan, raga, lullaby).

2. Lie on your side or sit propped up.

3. Let your breath slow with the music.

🕒 Music lowered anxiety in pregnancy trials; effects are modest.

Safety: Keep volume comfortable; never place headphones on the belly.

🧘 BODY

🕒 10 min

Side-lying rest

Side-lying rest with pillows.

1. Lie on your left or right side.

2. Pillow between the knees, one under the belly, one under the head.

3. Relax the jaw, hands and feet with each out-breath.

🕒 Side-lying avoids pressure on major blood vessels; relaxation lowers stress.

⚠️ Check with your doctor first. Safety: After the first trimester, avoid lying flat on your back. **Stop if:** pain, bleeding, dizziness, breathlessness, fluid leakage or contractions.

💖 HEART

🕒 10 min

Record a voice message

Which sounds do you want baby to know?

🕒 A keepsake of familiar voices.

🌙 SPIRIT

🕒 5 min

Moon gazing

Look at the moon tonight.

🌑 🌓 🌕 🌑

1. Find the moon tonight from a safe, comfortable spot.

2. Note its shape on the moon tracker.

3. Breathe slowly and tell baby what you see.

🕒 Mindful moments in nature support calm.

Safety: Stay in safe, familiar places after dark.

🍲 NOURISH

🕒 10 min

Curd rice with til tempering

Curd and sesame give calcium for bones and teeth.

Simple recipe: Mix soft rice with fresh curd and a little milk. Temper with mustard seeds, curry leaves and a spoon of til. Add grated carrot.

🕒 Calcium foods

✓ Set curd from boiled or pasteurised milk.

✗ Don't take calcium and iron tablets together — space them out.

For baby's bones and teeth, and your own.

⚠️ Check with your doctor first.

WEEKLY CHECK-IN

MOOD

☹️ ☹️ ☹️ 😊 😊

WATER (GLASSES/DAY)

🍵 🍵 🍵 🍵 🍵 🍵 🍵 🍵 🍵 🍵

BABY'S PATTERN

☐ felt flutters / movement

PARTNER TASK

☐ Make a 'calm sounds' playlist with her (page 72).

SLEEP (HRS/NIGHT)

ENERGY

🔄 🔄 🔄 🔄 🔄

ONE CALM MINUTE 🕒

Name 3 sounds you can hear right now.

Week 23 • Trimester 2 50

WEEK

24

TRIMESTER 2

Jivana जीवन
Life



about the size of a **corn
cob (bhutta)**
≈ 30 cm · ≈ 600 g

Baby this week

The lungs are forming branches. The glucose (sugar) test is often done between 24 and 28 weeks.

HONEST NOTE

From now on, report any reduction in baby's movements straight away.

MIND

5 min

Gāyatrī mantra

Gāyatrī — or a favourite poem (page 20).

1. Read the meaning first (page 20).
2. Recite slowly 3 or 9 times, or listen to it.
3. Reflect: 'May my mind be bright and kind.'

Heritage prayer (Rgveda 3.62.10); mantra practice may calm the mind — studies are weak.

Safety: Some families follow initiation customs — follow yours, or choose another prayer.

BODY

5 min

Pelvic-floor squeezes

Pelvic-floor squeezes, 3 times a day.

1. Gently squeeze as if stopping wind and urine; lift up and in.
2. Hold 3–5 seconds while breathing normally; release fully.
3. Repeat 8–10 times, 3 times a day.

Strong evidence: reduces leaking urine late in pregnancy and after birth.

Check with your doctor first. Safety: Don't practise while passing urine. Stop if painful. **Stop if:** pain, bleeding, dizziness, breathlessness, fluid leakage or contractions.

HEART

5 min

Worry to wish

Worry to wish:

'When troubled by thoughts, cultivate the opposite' — Yoga Sūtra 2.33.

SPIRIT

5 min

Kind wishes (maitrī)

Kind wishes for everyone in your family.



1. Silently wish: 'May I be well. May my baby be well.'
2. Widen to family, friends, all beings.
3. Rest in the warmth.

Loving-kindness practice raises positive feelings; Yoga Sūtra 1.33.

NOURISH

Omega-3 fats

Mackerel (bangda) or sardine curry / walnut-flax ladoo

Omega-3 fats build the brain and eyes and lower the risk of early birth.

Simple recipe: Fish: cook bangda or sardine in a tomato-coconut curry until flaky. Vegetarian: blend dates, walnuts and roasted flaxseed; roll small ladoos.

✓ Low-mercury fish 2–3 times a week; ask about DHA if vegetarian.

✗ Avoid shark, swordfish, king mackerel (surmai — check locally) and big-eye tuna.

Omega-3 fats lower the risk of early birth and build brain and eyes.

Check with your doctor first.

WEEKLY CHECK-IN

MOOD



SLEEP
(HRS/NIGHT)

WATER

(GLASSES/DAY)



ENERGY



BABY'S PATTERN

☐ normal for my baby

PARTNER TASK

☐ Go with her for the sugar (GTT) test; bring a snack for afterwards.

ONE CALM MINUTE

Breathe in 'life', breathe out 'love'.

WEEK

25

TRIMESTER 2

Kamala कमल

Lotus



about the size of a
cauliflower
≈ 34.6 cm · ≈ 660 g

Baby this week
The hands are fully formed and baby responds to both touch and sound. Hair is growing.

HONEST NOTE
In a small study, babies moved more when their mothers stroked their belly.

📖 MIND

10 min

Indian story time
Read ‘Rāma and the Squirrel’ (page 25).

1. Read one of the stories on pages 24–25 aloud.
2. Use different voices for the characters.
3. Talk about the story’s kindness or courage.

●

Reading aloud = your voice for baby. The story’s values are for the family to share.

🧘 BODY

5 min

Tree pose at the wall
Tree pose — always beside a wall.

1. Stand side-on to a wall, one hand on it.
2. Rest the other foot on your ankle or calf (never the knee).
3. 3–5 breaths; swap sides.

🕒

Balance work with support; falls are the main risk, so the wall is essential.

⚠

Check with your doctor first. Safety: Always use the wall. Skip if balance feels unsure. **Stop if:** pain, bleeding, dizziness, breathlessness, fluid leakage or contractions.

💖 HEART

2 min

Belly-touch hello
What did baby do when you touched your belly?

🕒

In a small study, babies moved more when mothers touched their belly.

🛡

Safety: Gentle touch only.

🌸 SPIRIT

5 min

Lotus visualisation
Lotus visualisation, 5 minutes.

1. Close your eyes; imagine a lotus on still water.
2. With each out-breath, one petal opens.
3. Rest in the open flower.

🕒

Guided imagery may ease anxiety; studies are small.

🍽 NOURISH

● Tastes of home

Mixed vegetable sambar or dal
Varied home flavours reach the amniotic fluid; baby gets to ‘taste’ your family’s food.

Simple recipe: Cook toor dal with pumpkin, drumstick, carrot and beans. Add tamarind, sambar powder and a curry-leaf tempering. Eat with rice or idli.

✓

Eat a rainbow of seasonal vegetables.

✗

Avoid very spicy, oily food if you have heartburn.

👉

Flavours reach the amniotic fluid; babies may later accept familiar tastes more easily.

⚠

Check with your doctor first.

WEEKLY CHECK-IN

MOOD

☹ ☹ ☹ ☹ ☹

WATER (GLASSES/DAY)

UUUUUUUUUU

BABY’S PATTERN

☐ normal for my baby

PARTNER TASK

☐ Give a gentle hand or foot massage.

SLEEP (HRS/NIGHT)

ENERGY

OOOOOO

ONE CALM MINUTE 🕒

Picture a lotus rising clean from muddy water.

WEEK

26

TRIMESTER 2

Netra नेत्र

Eyes



about the size of a **small cabbage**
 ≈ 35.6 cm · ≈ 760 g

Baby this week

Around 26–28 weeks the eyes begin to open and blink. Baby may react to bright light through your belly.

HONEST NOTE

Sight is the last sense to mature — most of it develops after birth.

MIND

5 min

Sing a lullaby

Sing to baby before sleep.

1. Choose one lullaby (pages 22–23) or a family favourite.
2. Sing softly, as many times as you like.
3. Keep the same song for the coming weeks.

● Newborns show memory for sounds heard before birth; singing may also help bonding.

BODY

10 min

Partner foot & hand massage

Partner foot and hand massage.

1. Partner uses plain oil or lotion.
2. Slow, gentle strokes on hands and feet.
3. Talk, listen to music, or sit in silence together.

● Small studies link massage with lower anxiety.

✚ **Check with your doctor first. Safety:** No strong essential oils; skip a swollen or painful calf. **Stop if:** pain, bleeding, dizziness, breathlessness, fluid leakage or contractions.

HEART

5 min

Three good things

Three good things from this week:

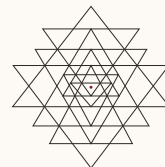
● Gratitude exercises have small positive effects on wellbeing.

SPIRIT

3 min

Soft gaze at a yantra

Soft gaze at the yantra (or a flower).



1. Place the yantra (page 17) at eye level, arm's length.
2. Look softly at the centre dot (bindu); blink freely.
3. Close your eyes and rest. 1–3 minutes.

✚ A contemplative heritage practice — not a medical treatment.

Safety: Blink normally; stop if your eyes strain or water.

NOURISH

Palak moong dal

Spinach and moong give folate, iron and protein.

Simple recipe: Cook ½ cup moong dal till soft. Add 2 cups chopped washed palak, a tempering of jeera, garlic and a pinch of haldi; simmer 5 min. Finish with lemon.

● Folate foods

✓ Wash leafy greens well in running water.

✗ Don't skip prescribed folic acid tablets.

Folate helps form the baby's brain and spine. Take folic acid tablets as your doctor prescribes.

✚ **Check with your doctor first.**

WEEKLY CHECK-IN

MOOD

SLEEP
(HRS/NIGHT)

WATER
(GLASSES/DAY)

ENERGY



BABY'S PATTERN

☐ normal for my baby

PARTNER TASK

☐ Massage her feet this week (BODY box).

ONE CALM MINUTE

Close your eyes; see soft golden light.

WEEK

27

TRIMESTER 2

Sandhi सन्धि

Threshold



about the size of a
drumstick bunch
≈ 36.6 cm · ≈ 880 g

Baby this week

The second trimester ends. Baby has regular sleep–wake cycles and a very active brain.

HONEST NOTE

The third trimester begins next week — side sleeping and movement awareness become important.

MIND

5 min

Madālasā's lullaby

Madālasā's lullaby (page 21).

1. Read the verse and its meaning (page 21).
2. Sing or speak it softly to baby.
3. Write one quality you wish for your child.

✦ A lullaby of wisdom from the Purāṇic tradition — shared here as heritage.

BODY

5 min

Open seated twist

Open seated twist on a chair.

1. Sit sideways on a chair.
2. Turn the chest gently towards the chair back — away from the belly.
3. 3 breaths each side; twist from the upper back only.

● Gentle mobility; deep twists are avoided in pregnancy.

✦ **Check with your doctor first. Safety:** No deep or closed twists. Skip if uncomfortable. **Stop if:** pain, bleeding, dizziness, breathlessness, fluid leakage or contractions.

HEART

10 min

Letter to baby

A letter to close the second trimester:

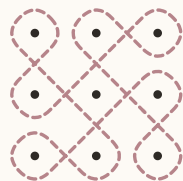
● Writing about feelings can ease stress; it also deepens connection.

SPIRIT

10 min

Kolam on dots

Draw a kolam for the threshold of your home.



1. Use the dot grid on page 18.
2. Draw one continuous line around the dots.
3. Let mistakes be part of the pattern.

✦ Threshold art drawn at dawn across South India.

NOURISH

Vegetable poha with peanuts

Poha (with lemon) gives iron; peanuts add protein and choline; vegetables add fibre.

Simple recipe: Rinse thick poha. Sauté mustard, curry leaves, onion, peas and carrot; add haldi, poha and roasted peanuts. Finish with lemon and coriander.

● Protein at every meal

✓ Add a fruit for vitamin C.

✗ Don't skip breakfast.

Needs rise in the 2nd and 3rd trimesters.

✦ **Check with your doctor first.**

WEEKLY CHECK-IN

MOOD



SLEEP
(HRS/NIGHT)

WATER
(GLASSES/DAY)



ENERGY



BABY'S PATTERN

☐ normal for my baby

PARTNER TASK

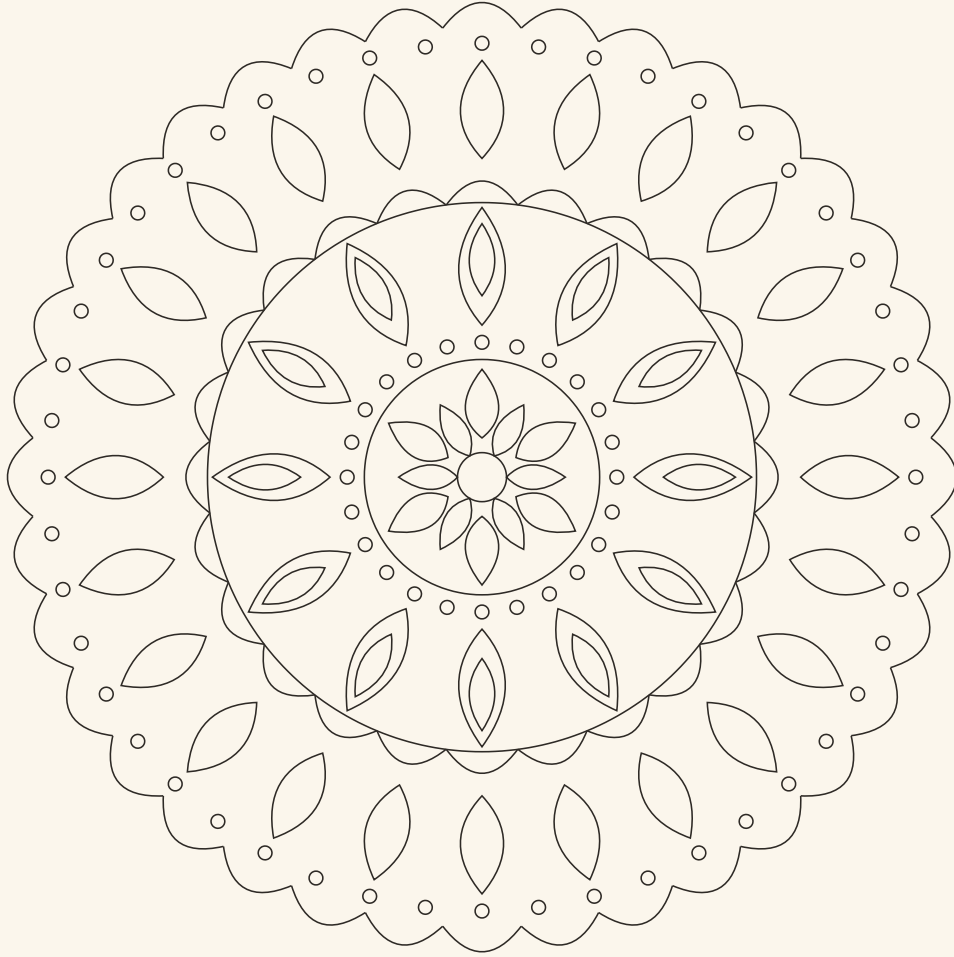
☐ Start planning the godh bharai / sīmantham (page 75).

ONE CALM MINUTE ●

Stand in a doorway. Breathe. Step through.

Flower mandala

Puṣpa — blossoming. Choose three colours and repeat them around the circle.



Trimester 2 — reflection

What surprised me this trimester

What I am proud of

What I want to carry into the next weeks

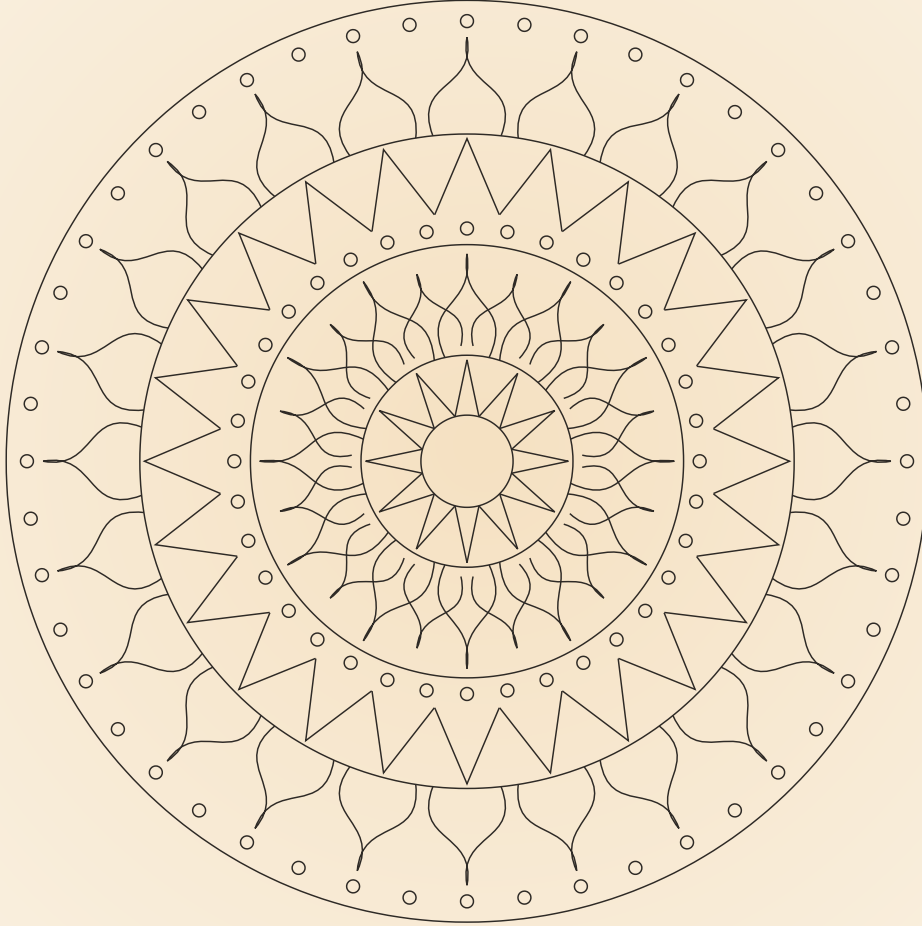
TRIMESTER 3 · WEEKS 28-40

Puṣpa पुष्प

The Bloom

Baby grows fast and gets ready for the world. Go to sleep on your side, learn your baby's movement pattern, and gather your circle of support.

- Side sleeping and rest
- Knowing baby's movements
- Preparing for birth and home



समत्वं योग उच्यते

samatvaṁ yoga ucyate — Evenness of mind is called yoga. (Bhagavad Gītā 2.48)
Colour the mandala slowly, one ring at a time. 🕒 Structured colouring may ease anxiety.

WEEK

28

TRIMESTER 3

Smarana स्मरण

Remembering



about the size of a **large brinjal**
≈ 37.6 cm · ≈ 1.0 kg

Baby this week

Baby can open the eyes and respond to light. This week begins the third trimester.

HONEST NOTE

Science-backed: from now on, go to sleep on your side — it lowers the risk of stillbirth.

MIND

10 min

Same story, same song

Begin 'same story, same song' — every evening until birth.

1. Pick ONE short story and ONE song.
2. Read and sing them every evening from now until birth.
3. After birth, use them to soothe — they may sound familiar.

● In studies, newborns recognised passages and melodies heard often before birth.

BODY

10 min

Side-lying rest

Practise falling asleep on your side.

1. Lie on your left or right side.
2. Pillow between the knees, one under the belly, one under the head.
3. Relax the jaw, hands and feet with each out-breath.

● Side-lying avoids pressure on major blood vessels; relaxation lowers stress.

⊕ **Check with your doctor first. Safety:** After the first trimester, avoid lying flat on your back. **Stop if:** pain, bleeding, dizziness, breathlessness, fluid leakage or contractions.

HEART

10 min

Partner task of the week

What help would make the next 12 weeks easier?

● Practical and emotional support protects a mother's wellbeing.

SPIRIT

2 min

One calm minute

One calm minute at bedtime.



1. Set a 1-minute timer.
2. Notice 3 sounds, 2 sensations, 1 breath.
3. Smile at baby before you get up.

● Short mindfulness pauses; pregnancy research is encouraging but mixed.

NOURISH

Ragi dosa with tomato chutney

Ragi gives iron and calcium; tomato's vitamin C helps absorb iron.

Simple recipe: Mix 1 cup ragi flour, ¼ cup rice flour, curd and water to a thin batter with onion and coriander. Cook thin dosas. Serve with fresh tomato chutney.

● Iron + vitamin C

✓ Pair iron foods with amla, lemon, guava or tomato.

✗ Avoid tea or coffee within an hour of meals.

Iron builds blood for two; vitamin C helps absorb it.

⊕ **Check with your doctor first.**

WEEKLY CHECK-IN

MOOD



SLEEP (HRS/NIGHT)

WATER (GLASSES/DAY)



ENERGY



BABY'S PATTERN

☐ normal for my baby

PARTNER TASK

☐ Set up pillows for side sleeping.

ONE CALM MINUTE ●

Turn to your side. Breathe. Rest.

WEEK

29

TRIMESTER 3

Mrdu मृदु

Gentleness



about the size of a **small pumpkin**
≈ 38.6 cm · ≈ 1.1 kg

Baby this week
Muscles and lungs are maturing. Kicks and stretches are strong and easy to feel.

HONEST NOTE
Know your baby's pattern. If movements slow down or change, call your hospital at once — don't wait.

📖 MIND

10 min

Same story, same song

Your same story, same song.

1. Pick ONE short story and ONE song.

2. Read and sing them every evening from now until birth.

3. After birth, use them to soothe — they may sound familiar.

● In studies, newborns recognised passages and melodies heard often before birth.

🧘 BODY

5 min

Wall pelvic tilts

Wall pelvic tilts for back ease.

1. Stand with your back against a wall, knees soft.

2. Breathe out: gently press the low back towards the wall.

3. Breathe in: release. 8–10 times.

● Simple back care used widely in antenatal classes.

⚠️ Check with your doctor first. Safety: Small, comfortable range only. Stop if: pain, bleeding, dizziness, breathlessness, fluid leakage or contractions.

💖 HEART

5 min

Imagine meeting baby

Imagine the first time baby hears your voice outside the womb.

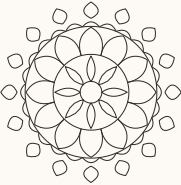
💡 Thinking about baby is linked with bonding after birth.

🌸 SPIRIT

20 min

Mandala colouring

Colour the sun mandala (page 56).



1. Choose 2–3 calm colours.

2. Colour from the centre outwards, slowly.

3. Notice your breath as you work.

💡 Structured colouring reduced anxiety in small studies.

🥣 NOURISH

Protein at every meal

Steamed sprout chaat

Sprouts are rich in protein, folate and fibre.

Simple recipe: Steam moong sprouts 5–7 min until soft. Toss with chopped cucumber, tomato, roasted jeera, lemon and coriander.

✓ Steam or cook sprouts.

✗ Avoid raw sprouts in pregnancy (germ risk).

Needs rise in the 2nd and 3rd trimesters.

⚠️ Check with your doctor first.

WEEKLY CHECK-IN

MOOD

☹️ ☹️ ☹️ 😊 😊

WATER (GLASSES/DAY)

UUUUUUUUUU

BABY'S PATTERN

☐ normal for my baby

☐ Learn the movement rule: if baby moves less, call the hospital now.

SLEEP (HRS/NIGHT)

ENERGY

OOOOOO

ONE CALM MINUTE

Be gentle with yourself today.

Week 29 · Trimester 3 58

WEEK

30
TRIMESTER 3

Prakāśa प्रकाश
Light



about the size of a **large cabbage**
≈ 39.9 cm · ≈ 1.3 kg

Baby this week

The brain's surface is folding into ridges as it grows quickly.

HONEST NOTE

Your nourishing food, sleep and calm all support this growth — there are no shortcuts or guarantees.

MIND

5 min

Lullaby in your mother tongue

Your mother-tongue lullaby.

1. Choose a lullaby in your home language (pages 22–23).
2. Ask an elder how they sang it.
3. Sing it to baby — the melody of your language is a welcome.

Newborns are already tuned to the sound patterns of the language they heard in the womb.

BODY

5 min

Bhrāmarī — humming bee

Humming bee breath before sleep.

1. Sit comfortably; close your eyes.
2. Breathe in through the nose; breathe out humming softly 'mmm'.
3. Optional: fingers lightly over the ears. 5–7 rounds.

Humming lengthens the out-breath; research is early and small.

Check with your doctor first. Safety: No breath-holding; don't press the ears; stop if dizzy. **Stop if:** pain, bleeding, dizziness, breathlessness, fluid leakage or contractions.

HEART

5 min

Partner's voice for baby

What does baby's other parent sing or say?

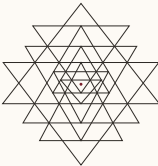
Babies hear voices outside the womb from mid-pregnancy.

SPIRIT

20 min

Trace the Śrī Yantra

Colour the Śrī Yantra petals.



1. Trace the nine triangles slowly with a pencil.
2. Colour the petals, starting from the outside.
3. End by resting your gaze at the centre.

Sacred geometry of the Śrī Vidyā tradition; shared as heritage art.

NOURISH

Egg bhurji or soya-paneer bhurji

Eggs are the richest everyday source of choline; soya and paneer help vegetarians.

Simple recipe: Sauté onion, tomato, haldi and jeera. Add 2 beaten eggs (or crumbled paneer + soaked soya granules). Cook until fully firm. Eat with a roti and salad.

Choline foods

- ✓ Cook eggs until yolk and white are firm.
- ✗ No half-boiled or raw eggs (including in homemade mayonnaise).

Choline supports brain development; a small trial found benefits from higher intake.

Check with your doctor first.

WEEKLY CHECK-IN

MOOD



SLEEP
(HRS/NIGHT)

WATER

(GLASSES/DAY)



ENERGY



BABY'S PATTERN

☐ normal for my baby

PARTNER TASK

☐ Prepare the documents folder for the hospital bag (page 78).

ONE CALM MINUTE

Picture morning light filling the room.

WEEK

31

TRIMESTER 3

Prema प्रेम

Love



about the size of a
coconut
≈ 41.1 cm · ≈ 1.5 kg

Baby this week
All five senses are working. Baby turns the head and may hiccup — you may feel little rhythmic jumps.

HONEST NOTE
Hiccups are normal and harmless.

📖 MIND

10 min

Same story, same song
Your same story, same song.

1. Pick ONE short story and ONE song.
2. Read and sing them every evening from now until birth.
3. After birth, use them to soothe — they may sound familiar.

● In studies, newborns recognised passages and melodies heard often before birth.

🧘 BODY

5 min

Supported butterfly
Supported butterfly.

1. Sit on a folded blanket; soles of feet together.
2. Cushions under the knees; spine tall.
3. Breathe slowly for 1–2 minutes. No bouncing.

● A common, gentle hip-opener in prenatal yoga programmes.

⚠️ **Check with your doctor first. Safety:** Skip if you have pelvic (pubic) pain. **Stop if:** pain, bleeding, dizziness, breathlessness, fluid leakage or contractions.

💖 HEART

10 min

Letter to baby
What is love teaching you right now?

🕒 Writing about feelings can ease stress; it also deepens connection.

🕉 SPIRIT

5 min

Kind wishes (maitrī)
Kind wishes for baby.



1. Silently wish: ‘May I be well. May my baby be well.’
2. Widen to family, friends, all beings.
3. Rest in the warmth.

🕒 Loving-kindness practice raises positive feelings; Yoga Sūtra 1.33.

🍲 NOURISH

● Omega-3 fats

Mackerel (bangda) or sardine curry / walnut-flax ladoo
Omega-3 fats build the brain and eyes and lower the risk of early birth.

Simple recipe: Fish: cook bangda or sardine in a tomato-coconut curry until flaky. Vegetarian: blend dates, walnuts and roasted flaxseed; roll small ladoos.

✓ Low-mercury fish 2–3 times a week; ask about DHA if vegetarian.

✗ Avoid shark, swordfish, king mackerel (surmai — check locally) and big-eye tuna.

Omega-3 fats lower the risk of early birth and build brain and eyes.

⚠️ **Check with your doctor first.**

WEEKLY CHECK-IN

MOOD

☹ ☹ ☹ ☹ ☹

SLEEP (HRS/NIGHT)

WATER (GLASSES/DAY)

UUUUUUUUUU

ENERGY

OOOOOO

BABY'S PATTERN

☐ normal for my baby

PARTNER TASK

☐ Write your own letter to baby.

ONE CALM MINUTE 🕒

Hand on heart, hand on belly.

WEEK

32
TRIMESTER 3

Dhairya धैर्य

Courage



about the size of a **small jackfruit**
≈ 42.4 cm · ≈ 1.7 kg

Baby this week

Baby practises breathing movements and has toenails. Many babies settle head-down around now.

HONEST NOTE

Breathing practice now is for you — slow breaths are a skill that helps in labour.

MIND

10 min

Indian story time

Read 'Hanumān's Leap' (page 25).

1. Read one of the stories on pages 24–25 aloud.
2. Use different voices for the characters.
3. Talk about the story's kindness or courage.

● Reading aloud = your voice for baby. The story's values are for the family to share.

BODY

20 min

Daily walk

Shorter, slower walks.

1. Walk at a pace where you can still talk.
2. Build slowly towards 150 minutes a week.
3. Walk in cooler hours; carry water.

● WHO and ACOG recommend regular moderate activity for most pregnancies.

⚠ **Check with your doctor first. Safety:** Stop with any warning sign (bleeding, pain, dizziness, fluid, contractions). **Stop if:** pain, bleeding, dizziness, breathlessness, fluid leakage or contractions.

HEART

5 min

Worry to wish

What gives you courage?

● 'When troubled by thoughts, cultivate the opposite' — Yoga Sūtra 2.33.

SPIRIT

2 min

Mudrā & breath

Añjali mudrā with three breaths.



1. Choose a mudrā from page 15.
2. Rest the hands on your thighs or belly.
3. Breathe slowly for 2 minutes.

✦ Hand gestures from ritual, dance and meditation; healing claims are unproven.

NOURISH

Curd rice with til tempering

Curd and sesame give calcium for bones and teeth.

Simple recipe: Mix soft rice with fresh curd and a little milk. Temper with mustard seeds, curry leaves and a spoon of til. Add grated carrot.

● Calcium foods

- ✓ Set curd from boiled or pasteurised milk.
- ✗ Don't take calcium and iron tablets together — space them out.

For baby's bones and teeth, and your own.

⚠ **Check with your doctor first.**

WEEKLY CHECK-IN

MOOD



SLEEP (HRS/NIGHT)

WATER (GLASSES/DAY)



ENERGY



BABY'S PATTERN

☐ normal for my baby

PARTNER TASK

☐ Visit the hospital: find parking and the labour ward.

ONE CALM MINUTE

Breathe in courage, breathe out fear.

WEEK

33
TRIMESTER 3

Sneha स्नेह
Affection



about the size of a **bottle gourd (lauki)**
≈ 43.7 cm · ≈ 1.9 kg

Baby this week

Bones are hardening (the skull stays soft for birth). Antibodies pass to baby from you.

HONEST NOTE

Your antibodies give baby some early protection after birth.

MIND

5 min

Sing a lullaby

Sing the family lullaby.

1. Choose one lullaby (pages 22–23) or a family favourite.
2. Sing softly, as many times as you like.
3. Keep the same song for the coming weeks.

● Newborns show memory for sounds heard before birth; singing may also help bonding.

BODY

5 min

Ankle circles & calf stretch

Ankle circles and calf stretch.

1. Seated: circle each ankle 10 times each way.
2. Standing at a wall: step one foot back, heel down, 3 breaths.
3. Swap legs.

● Gentle movement for circulation and comfort.

✚ **Check with your doctor first. Safety:** One-sided calf pain or swelling: call your doctor at once. **Stop if:** pain, bleeding, dizziness, breathlessness, fluid leakage or contractions.

HEART

5 min

A family blessing

Write one blessing from an elder:

✚ Blessings by elders are a heart of Indian pregnancy celebrations.

SPIRIT

5 min

Cakra check-in

Heart (Anāhata) check-in: who do you feel close to?



1. Use the map on page 14.
2. Ask: where do I feel tense, warm, open?
3. Say the affirmation for that place.

✚ A symbolic map from the tantric tradition — not anatomy or medicine.

NOURISH

Jeera chaas & nimbu pani

Fluids help with constipation, swelling and urine infections.

Simple recipe: Chaas: whisk curd with water, roasted jeera, a pinch of salt and mint. Nimbu pani: lemon, water, a little jaggery, pinch of salt.

● Water & fluids

✓ 8–10 glasses of fluid a day unless told otherwise.

✗ Limit sugary drinks and packaged juices.

Helps with constipation, swelling and urine infections.

✚ Check with your doctor first.

WEEKLY CHECK-IN

MOOD



SLEEP
(HRS/NIGHT)

WATER
(GLASSES/DAY)



ENERGY



BABY'S PATTERN

☐ normal for my baby

PARTNER TASK

☐ Arrange support for the first weeks at home.

ONE CALM MINUTE

Think of someone who loves you.

WEEK

34
TRIMESTER 3Āśīrvāda आशीर्वाद
Blessingabout the size of a
muskmelon
≈ 45 cm • ≈ 2.1 kg

Baby this week

The lungs are maturing and fat is giving baby a rounder look.
Many families hold the godh bharaī / śīmantham around now.

HONEST NOTE

Celebrations are about joy and support — no sex-prediction games or rituals.

MIND

5 min

A Śānti (peace) mantra

Pūrṇamadaḥ — 'from fullness, fullness comes' (page 21).

1. Choose Saha nāvavatu, Asato mā or Pūrṇamadaḥ (pages 20–21).
2. Recite slowly, ending with 'śāntiḥ' three times.
3. Rest your hands on your belly and feel the stillness.

Peace prayers from the Upaniṣads; calm comes mostly from slow, steady breath.

BODY

10 min

Side-lying rest

Rest after the celebration.

1. Lie on your left or right side.
2. Pillow between the knees, one under the belly, one under the head.
3. Relax the jaw, hands and feet with each out-breath.

Side-lying avoids pressure on major blood vessels; relaxation lowers stress.

Check with your doctor first. **Safety:** After the first trimester, avoid lying flat on your back. **Stop if:** pain, bleeding, dizziness, breathlessness, fluid leakage or contractions.

HEART

5 min

A family blessing

Blessings received:

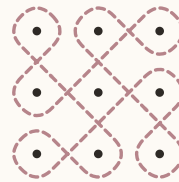
Blessings by elders are a heart of Indian pregnancy celebrations.

SPIRIT

10 min

Kolam on dots

Draw a rangoli or kolam for the celebration.



1. Use the dot grid on page 18.
2. Draw one continuous line around the dots.
3. Let mistakes be part of the pattern.

Threshold art drawn at dawn across South India.

NOURISH

Light milk kheer or daliya

Milk gives calcium and protein. Classical texts recommended milk-based gruels in late pregnancy (heritage note, page 27).

Simple recipe: Cook 3 tbsp broken wheat or rice in 2 cups boiled milk until soft. Sweeten lightly with jaggery; add cardamom and chopped nuts.

Calcium foods

✓ Small portions, as part of a balanced day.

✗ If you have diabetes in pregnancy, ask before adding sweets.

For baby's bones and teeth, and your own.

Check with your doctor first.

WEEKLY CHECK-IN

MOOD

SLEEP
(HRS/NIGHT)

WATER
(GLASSES/DAY)

ENERGY



BABY'S PATTERN

☐ normal for my baby

PARTNER TASK

☐ Host the celebration so she only has to rest and enjoy.

ONE CALM MINUTE

Receive. You don't have to do anything.

WEEK

35
TRIMESTER 3

Viśrānti विश्रान्ति

Rest



about the size of a ash
gourd (petha)
≈ 46.2 cm · ≈ 2.4 kg

Baby this week

The kidneys are fully developed. Most growth now is weight gain.

HONEST NOTE

Sleep may be harder now — rest whenever you can, on your side.

MIND

20 min

Sound bath

A 20-minute sound bath.

1. Make a playlist on page 72: rain, birds, flute, veena.
2. Lie on your side with a pillow between your knees.
3. Listen without doing anything else.

Listening to calming sound can reduce anxiety; evidence is modest.

Safety: Comfortable volume only.

BODY

20 min

Guided relaxation (yoga nidrā)

Guided relaxation, side-lying.

1. Lie on your side, well supported.
2. Move attention slowly: feet, legs, hips, belly, hands, face.
3. Rest in stillness; rise slowly via your side.

Guided relaxation lowered perceived stress in an Indian trial.

Check with your doctor first. Safety: Never flat on your back after the first trimester. **Stop if:** pain, bleeding, dizziness, breathlessness, fluid leakage or contractions.

HEART

5 min

Three good things

Three good things from this week:

Gratitude exercises have small positive effects on wellbeing.

SPIRIT

2 min

One calm minute

One calm minute after waking.



1. Set a 1-minute timer.
2. Notice 3 sounds, 2 sensations, 1 breath.
3. Smile at baby before you get up.

Short mindfulness pauses; pregnancy research is encouraging but mixed.

NOURISH

Dates, til & nut chikki

Til, jaggery and dates give iron and energy for the last weeks.

Simple recipe: Roast til and chopped nuts; mix with melted jaggery and chopped dates; press into a plate and cut squares. One piece is a portion.

Iron + vitamin C

✓ Keep healthy snacks ready for the hospital bag.

✗ Mind the portion — jaggery is still sugar.

Iron builds blood for two; vitamin C helps absorb it.

Check with your doctor first.

WEEKLY CHECK-IN

MOOD



SLEEP
(HRS/NIGHT)

WATER
(GLASSES/DAY)



ENERGY



BABY'S PATTERN

☐ normal for my baby

PARTNER TASK

☐ Plan safe transport to hospital (and a car seat if you drive).

ONE CALM MINUTE

Let the bed hold all your weight.

WEEK

36

TRIMESTER 3

Prastuti प्रस्तुति

Readiness



about the size of a **bunch of bananas**
≈ 47.4 cm · ≈ 2.6 kg

Baby this week

Baby is getting ready. The head may 'engage' (drop) into the pelvis, making breathing a little easier.

HONEST NOTE

Pack the hospital bag this week (page 78).

MIND

10 min

Same story, same song

Your same story, same song.

1. Pick ONE short story and ONE song.
2. Read and sing them every evening from now until birth.
3. After birth, use them to soothe — they may sound familiar.

● In studies, newborns recognised passages and melodies heard often before birth.

BODY

5 min

Wall pelvic tilts

Pelvic tilts for comfort.

1. Stand with your back against a wall, knees soft.
2. Breathe out: gently press the low back towards the wall.
3. Breathe in: release. 8–10 times.

● Simple back care used widely in antenatal classes.

⚠ **Check with your doctor first. Safety:** Small, comfortable range only. **Stop if:** pain, bleeding, dizziness, breathlessness, fluid leakage or contractions.

HEART

10 min

Record a voice message

Record your lullaby for baby. Which song?

🕒 A keepsake of familiar voices.

SPIRIT

2 min

Mudrā & breath

Apāna mudrā — traditionally kept for these last weeks.



1. Choose a mudrā from page 15.
2. Rest the hands on your thighs or belly.
3. Breathe slowly for 2 minutes.

✦ Hand gestures from ritual, dance and meditation; healing claims are unproven.

NOURISH

One mindful thali

Eating slowly helps you notice hunger and fullness.

Simple recipe: Once this week, eat one meal without screens. Notice colours, smells and textures. Put the spoon down between bites. Tell baby what you are eating.

🕒 Mindful meal

- ✓ Sit down to eat.
- ✗ Don't eat lying down if you have heartburn.

Eating slowly helps you notice hunger and fullness.

⚠ **Check with your doctor first.**

WEEKLY CHECK-IN

MOOD



SLEEP (HRS/NIGHT)

WATER (GLASSES/DAY)



ENERGY



BABY'S PATTERN

☐ normal for my baby

PARTNER TASK

☐ Practise the route to hospital — at night too.

ONE CALM MINUTE

Everything you need is already within you.

WEEK

37
TRIMESTER 3

Pūrṇatā पूर्णता
Fullness



about the size of a **snake gourd**
≈ 48.6 cm · ≈ 2.9 kg

Baby this week

Early term. Baby practises sucking and grasping and is ready for the outside world.

HONEST NOTE

Learn the newborn danger signs on page 80.

MIND

5 min

Lullaby in your mother tongue

Sing in your mother tongue.

1. Choose a lullaby in your home language (pages 22–23).
2. Ask an elder how they sang it.
3. Sing it to baby — the melody of your language is a welcome.

Newborns are already tuned to the sound patterns of the language they heard in the womb.

BODY

5 min

Natural belly breathing

Practise the long out-breath for labour.

1. Sit or lie on your side; hand on your belly.
2. Breathe in gently through the nose; feel the belly rise.
3. Breathe out a little longer than you breathe in (e.g., 4 in, 6 out).

Slow breathing is a well-established relaxation skill taught in antenatal classes.

Check with your doctor first. Safety: Stop if dizzy, tingly or breathless. **Stop if:** pain, bleeding, dizziness, breathlessness, fluid leakage or contractions.

HEART

5 min

Imagine meeting baby

Imagine your first hour together.

Thinking about baby is linked with bonding after birth.

SPIRIT

5 min

Lotus visualisation

Lotus visualisation.



1. Close your eyes; imagine a lotus on still water.
2. With each out-breath, one petal opens.
3. Rest in the open flower.

Guided imagery may ease anxiety; studies are small.

NOURISH

Jeera chaas & nimbu pani

Fluids help with constipation, swelling and urine infections.

Simple recipe: Chaas: whisk curd with water, roasted jeera, a pinch of salt and mint. Nimbu pani: lemon, water, a little jaggery, pinch of salt.

Water & fluids

✓ 8–10 glasses of fluid a day unless told otherwise.

✗ Limit sugary drinks and packaged juices.

Helps with constipation, swelling and urine infections.

Check with your doctor first.

WEEKLY CHECK-IN

MOOD



SLEEP
(HRS/NIGHT)

WATER
(GLASSES/DAY)



ENERGY



BABY'S PATTERN

☐ normal for my baby

PARTNER TASK

☐ Learn the newborn danger signs on page 80.

ONE CALM MINUTE

Breathe out longer than you breathe in.

WEEK

38

TRIMESTER 3

Dhyāna ध्यान

Stillness



about the size of a **medium pumpkin**
≈ 49.8 cm · ≈ 3.1 kg

Baby this week

The fine body hair (lanugo) is shedding. Baby is ready to meet you.

HONEST NOTE

Waiting is part of the journey. Most babies are born between 37 and 42 weeks.

MIND

10 min

Same story, same song

Your same story, same song.

1. Pick ONE short story and ONE song.
2. Read and sing them every evening from now until birth.
3. After birth, use them to soothe — they may sound familiar.

In studies, newborns recognised passages and melodies heard often before birth.

BODY

10 min

Side-lying rest

Side-lying rest every afternoon.

1. Lie on your left or right side.
2. Pillow between the knees, one under the belly, one under the head.
3. Relax the jaw, hands and feet with each out-breath.

Side-lying avoids pressure on major blood vessels; relaxation lowers stress.

Check with your doctor first. Safety: After the first trimester, avoid lying flat on your back. **Stop if:** pain, bleeding, dizziness, breathlessness, fluid leakage or contractions.

HEART

10 min

Letter to baby

A letter for 'almost there':

Writing about feelings can ease stress; it also deepens connection.

SPIRIT

2 min

One calm minute

Sit in stillness for one minute.



1. Set a 1-minute timer.
2. Notice 3 sounds, 2 sensations, 1 breath.
3. Smile at baby before you get up.

Short mindfulness pauses; pregnancy research is encouraging but mixed.

NOURISH

Tastes of home

Mixed vegetable sambar or dal

Varied home flavours reach the amniotic fluid; baby gets to 'taste' your family's food.

Simple recipe: Cook toor dal with pumpkin, drumstick, carrot and beans. Add tamarind, sambar powder and a curry-leaf tempering. Eat with rice or idli.

- ✓ Eat a rainbow of seasonal vegetables.
- ✗ Avoid very spicy, oily food if you have heartburn.

Flavours reach the amniotic fluid; babies may later accept familiar tastes more easily.

Check with your doctor first.

WEEKLY CHECK-IN

MOOD



SLEEP (HRS/NIGHT)

WATER (GLASSES/DAY)



ENERGY



BABY'S PATTERN

☐ normal for my baby

PARTNER TASK

☐ Cook and freeze two simple meals for after the birth.

ONE CALM MINUTE

Be still. Baby is near.

WEEK

39

TRIMESTER 3

Udaya उदय

Dawn



about the size of a **small watermelon**
≈ 50.7 cm · ≈ 3.3 kg

Baby this week
Baby is fully ready. The brain is still growing fast — and will keep growing for years after birth.

HONEST NOTE
Keep watching baby’s movements right up to birth; they should not slow down.

 MIND

5 min

Sing a lullaby

Sing to baby.

1. Choose one lullaby (pages 22–23) or a family favourite.

2. Sing softly, as many times as you like.

3. Keep the same song for the coming weeks.

● Newborns show memory for sounds heard before birth; singing may also help bonding.

 BODY

20 min

Daily walk

Short, easy walks.

1. Walk at a pace where you can still talk.

2. Build slowly towards 150 minutes a week.

3. Walk in cooler hours; carry water.

● WHO and ACOG recommend regular moderate activity for most pregnancies.

⊕ Check with your doctor first. Safety: Stop with any warning sign (bleeding, pain, dizziness, fluid, contractions). Stop if: pain, bleeding, dizziness, breathlessness, fluid leakage or contractions.

 HEART

10 min

Reach out

Who will you call first when baby arrives?

● Support from others protects mothers’ mental health.

 SPIRIT

5 min

Moon gazing

Look at the moon — a new phase is coming.









1. Find the moon tonight from a safe, comfortable spot.

2. Note its shape on the moon tracker.

3. Breathe slowly and tell baby what you see.

● Mindful moments in nature support calm.

Safety: Stay in safe, familiar places after dark.

 NOURISH

Iron + vitamin C

Ragi dosa with tomato chutney

Ragi gives iron and calcium; tomato’s vitamin C helps absorb iron.

Simple recipe: Mix 1 cup ragi flour, ¼ cup rice flour, curd and water to a thin batter with onion and coriander. Cook thin dosas. Serve with fresh tomato chutney.

✓ Pair iron foods with amla, lemon, guava or tomato.

✗ Avoid tea or coffee within an hour of meals.

Iron builds blood for two; vitamin C helps absorb it.

⊕ Check with your doctor first.

WEEKLY CHECK-IN

MOOD



SLEEP (HRS/NIGHT)

WATER (GLASSES/DAY)

ENERGY

BABY’S PATTERN

☐ normal for my baby

PARTNER TASK

☐ Keep your phone charged and stay reachable.

ONE CALM MINUTE

Imagine the first light of dawn.

Week 39 · Trimester 3 68

WEEK

40

TRIMESTER 3

Janma जन्म

Birth



about the size of a
watermelon
≈ 51.2 cm · ≈ 3.4 kg

Baby this week

Your due date. Only a few babies arrive exactly on the day — anywhere from 37 to 42 weeks is normal.

HONEST NOTE

If your pregnancy goes past the due date, your doctor will advise you on monitoring and next steps.

MIND

10 min

Same story, same song

Your story and song — one more time before you meet.

1. Pick ONE short story and ONE song.
2. Read and sing them every evening from now until birth.
3. After birth, use them to soothe — they may sound familiar.

● In studies, newborns recognised passages and melodies heard often before birth.

BODY

5 min

Natural belly breathing

Slow belly breathing.

1. Sit or lie on your side; hand on your belly.
2. Breathe in gently through the nose; feel the belly rise.
3. Breathe out a little longer than you breathe in (e.g., 4 in, 6 out).

● Slow breathing is a well-established relaxation skill taught in antenatal classes.

⚠ **Check with your doctor first. Safety:** Stop if dizzy, tingly or breathless. **Stop if:** pain, bleeding, dizziness, breathlessness, fluid leakage or contractions.

HEART

10 min

Letter to baby

Your final letter before you meet:

🕒 Writing about feelings can ease stress; it also deepens connection.

SPIRIT

5 min

Kind wishes (maitri)

Kind wishes for the birth and all who help.



1. Silently wish: 'May I be well. May my baby be well.'
2. Widen to family, friends, all beings.
3. Rest in the warmth.

🕒 Loving-kindness practice raises positive feelings; Yoga Sūtra 1.33.

NOURISH

Jeera chaas & nimbu pani

Fluids help with constipation, swelling and urine infections.

Simple recipe: Chaas: whisk curd with water, roasted jeera, a pinch of salt and mint. Nimbu pani: lemon, water, a little jaggery, pinch of salt.

● Water & fluids

✓ 8–10 glasses of fluid a day unless told otherwise.

✗ Limit sugary drinks and packaged juices.

Helps with constipation, swelling and urine infections.

⚠ **Check with your doctor first.**

WEEKLY CHECK-IN

MOOD



SLEEP
(HRS/NIGHT)

WATER
(GLASSES/DAY)



ENERGY



BABY'S PATTERN

☐ normal for my baby

PARTNER TASK

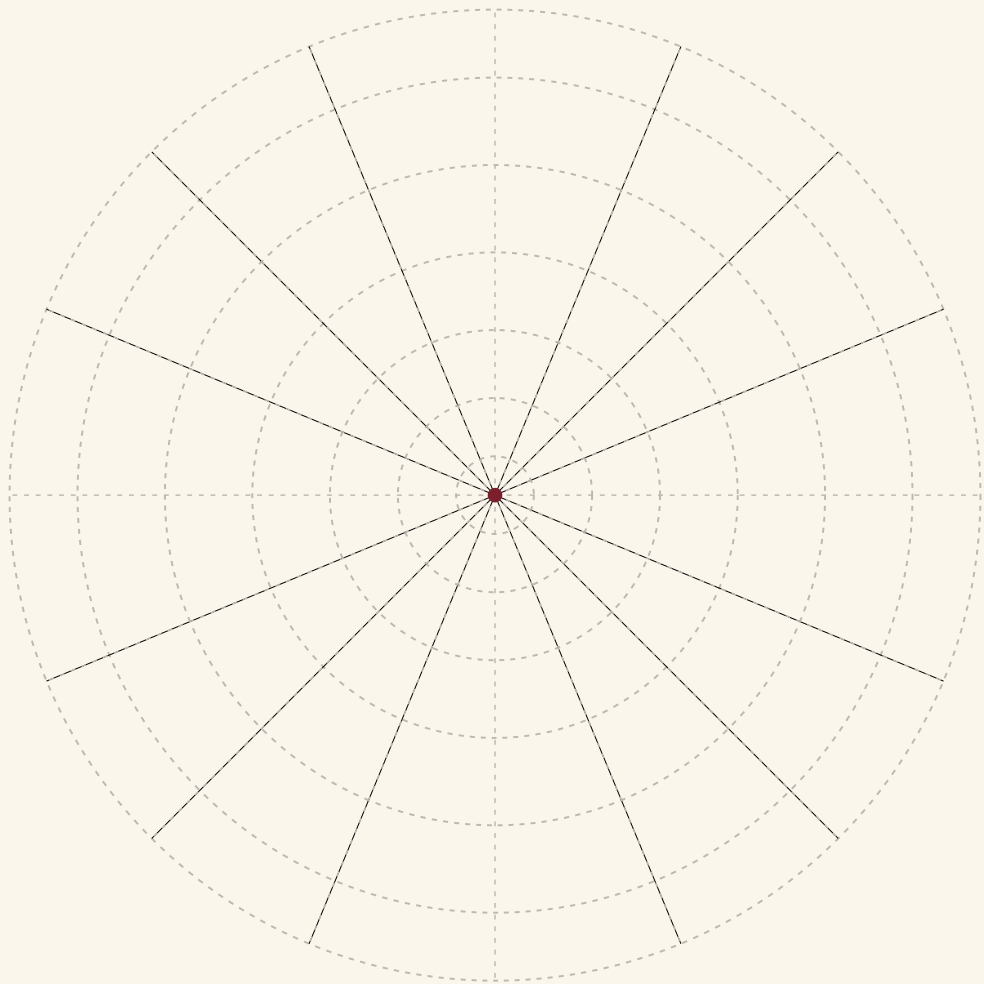
☐ Hold her hand. You are both ready.

ONE CALM MINUTE 🕒

Welcome, little one.

Draw your own mandala

Begin at the centre dot. Repeat a shape around each ring until it feels complete.



Trimester 3 — reflection

What surprised me this trimester

What I am proud of

What I want to carry into the next weeks

Daily rhythm



Morning calm (10 minutes)

- ☐ On waking, lie on your side; three slow breaths.
- ☐ A glass of water; a light snack if nauseous.
- ☐ Neck and shoulder release (2 minutes).
- ☐ Say good morning to baby by name.
- ☐ Choose one intention (saṅkalpa) for the day.



Evening wind-down (20 minutes)

- ☐ Screens off 30–60 minutes before bed.
- ☐ Warm bath or wash; loose, comfortable clothes.
- ☐ Same story, same song for baby.
- ☐ Three good things — said aloud or written.
- ☐ Go to sleep on your side, pillow between the knees (essential from 28 weeks).

● Waking on your back is not a cause for alarm — simply turn onto your side. Sources: ACOG 2020; Cronin 2019. 📌 Check with your doctor first.

My own rhythm

TIME	MORNING	AFTERNOON	EVENING
Mon			
Tue			
Wed			
Thu			
Fri			
Sat			
Sun			

Sound-bath playlist

Ideas: rain, birdsong, flute, veena, sitar ālāp, soft bhajans, a grandparent singing, ocean waves, your family's lullaby.

[illegible]

Keep the volume comfortable. Never place headphones on your belly.

Baby-talk prompts ●

- Good morning! Today the weather is...
- This is the sound of your father's / mother's / grandmother's voice...
- I am cooking... can you smell the jeera?
- Today I felt happy when...
- Your family is waiting for you. Your name might be...
- Let me tell you about the place where you will live...
- This song is our song...
- Goodnight. I love you. See you tomorrow.

Partner & family



Partner tasks ●

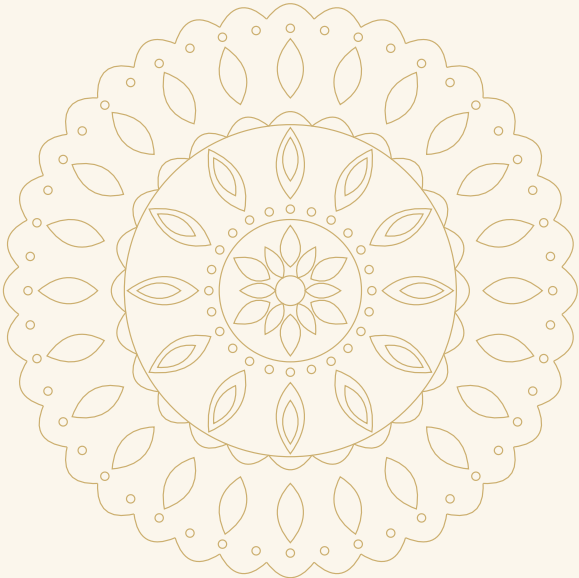
- ☐ Come to at least one scan or check-up each trimester.
- ☐ Take over cooking or cleaning on tired days.
- ☐ Learn the warning signs (page 8) and the movement rule.
- ☐ Talk, read or sing to the bump every evening.
- ☐ Give a foot or hand massage once a week.
- ☐ Pack the hospital bag together; plan transport.
- ☐ Protect her rest — be the gatekeeper for visitors.

Grandparents & elders ●

- ☐ Teach a family lullaby or story (page 73).
- ☐ Share the family's memories for the family tree.
- ☐ Offer a blessing — and practical help.
- ☐ Cook a favourite (pregnancy-safe) dish.
- ☐ Gently let go of old fears and taboos — reassure, don't restrict.

Voice messages & lullabies for baby

DATE	WHO	SONG / MESSAGE	WHERE IT IS SAVED



Our family tree

Fill in names, places and one word about each person.



GREAT-GRANDPARENTS

Grandmother

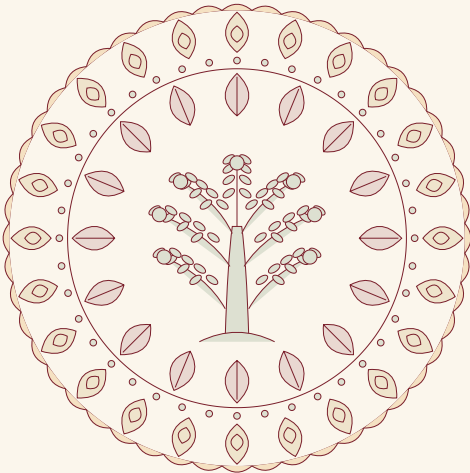
Grandfather

Grandmother

Grandfather

Mother

Partner



Baby

Celebration planner

Godh bharai · Sīmantham · Valaikāppu · Sādh · Dohāḷe jevaṇ · Baby shower



✦ Descended from the Vedic sīmantonnayana — when blessings and music surrounded the mother. Celebration only: let the mother sit, eat and enjoy. Please no sex-prediction games, rituals or remarks.

Date & time

Place

Hosted by

Guests

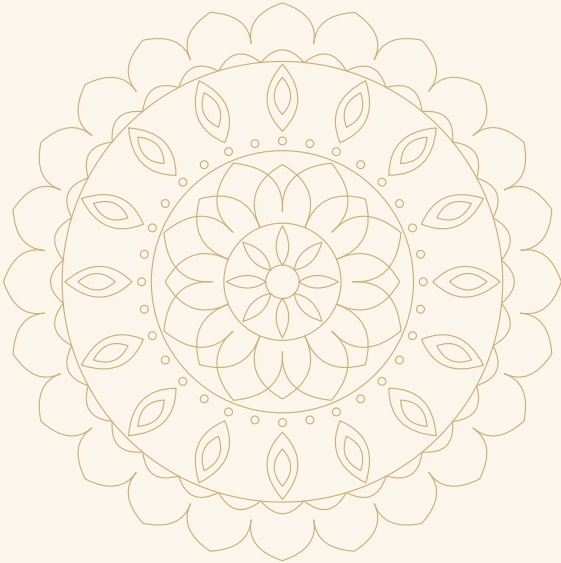
Food (pregnancy-safe)

Music / songs

Things to keep simple

Blessings received

FROM	BLESSING / WISH



Know your baby’s movements

From 28 weeks. There is no ‘right number’ of kicks — learn what is normal for YOUR baby.



Each day, note when baby is most active (morning / afternoon / evening / night) and tick if movements felt normal. If you are unsure, lie on your left side and focus on movements for up to 2 hours.

WEEK	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN	BUSIEST TIME
28	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
29	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
30	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
31	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
32	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
33	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
34	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
35	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
36	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
37	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
38	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
39	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
40	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	

If movements slow down, change or stop — do not wait until tomorrow. Call your doctor or hospital now. Do not rely on home Dopplers or apps.

● Source: RCOG Green-top Guideline 57 (2011).

Appointments & questions

[illegible]

Questions for my doctor

Hospital bag & home-ready checklist



For mother

- ☐ MCP card, reports, ID, insurance papers
- ☐ Loose nightwear (front-opening) ×3
- ☐ Maternity pads, underwear ×5
- ☐ Slippers, socks, shawl
- ☐ Toiletries, comb, lip balm
- ☐ Phone, charger, earphones
- ☐ Snacks (chikki, dry fruit) and water bottle
- ☐ Feeding bra / dupatta
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

For baby

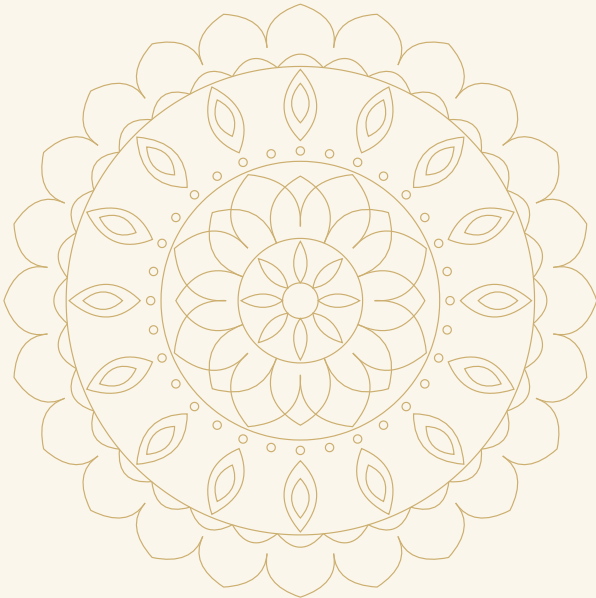
- ☐ Soft cotton clothes ×4, caps, mittens, socks
- ☐ Swaddle cloths / blankets ×3
- ☐ Nappies or cloth langots
- ☐ Going-home outfit
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

For partner

- ☐ Change of clothes, toothbrush
- ☐ Cash/UPI for emergencies
- ☐ Important phone numbers
- ☐ Something to read; patience!
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

Ready at home

- ☐ A clean, safe place for baby to sleep (on the back, firm flat surface)
- ☐ Help arranged for the first weeks
- ☐ Simple meals cooked and frozen
- ☐ Thermometer; doctor and hospital numbers on the fridge
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____



Pack by week 36. Keep your MCP card and reports in one folder.

Birth preferences

Talk these through with your doctor; birth can be unpredictable — flexibility is part of the plan.



My birth companion(s)

Movement and positions I'd like to try

Comfort measures (breathing, music, massage, warm water)

Pain relief I'd like to discuss

If a caesarean is needed, I'd like...

After birth: skin-to-skin, delayed cord clamping (discuss)

Feeding: start within the first hour

Anything about my faith or culture to respect

Other wishes

First weeks with baby



Feeding ●

- Start breastfeeding within the first hour if possible; skin-to-skin helps.
- Feed on demand — 8–12 times a day in the early weeks.
- Exclusive breastfeeding for six months is recommended (WHO).
- Ask your nurse, ASHA or a lactation counsellor for help early — it is common to need it.

Vaccinations & sleep ●

Follow the vaccination schedule on your Mother & Child Protection Card. Birth doses usually include BCG, OPV-0 and Hepatitis B.

Safe sleep: baby on the back, on a firm flat surface, nothing loose around the face.

Newborn danger signs — go to a doctor immediately

1. Not feeding well, or unable to suck
2. Fits (convulsions) or very floppy/unusually sleepy
3. Fast breathing or chest drawing in with each breath
4. Fever, or feels cold to touch
5. Yellow skin in the first 24 hours, or yellow palms and soles
6. Redness, pus or bleeding from the cord stump
7. Vomiting everything; very few wet nappies

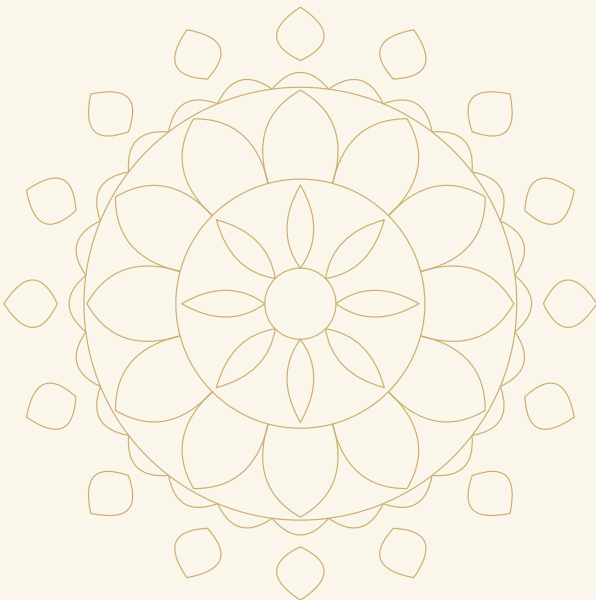
Useful numbers

Paediatrician _____

Lactation support _____

ASHA / ANM _____

Hospital _____



Sources: MoHFW MCP Card 2018; WHO.

Name ideas

Names, meanings and why we love them. (Nāmakaraṇa — the naming ceremony — is traditionally held around the 11th or 12th day.)

[illegible]

Some ideas: Aarav (peaceful), Aditi (boundless), Anaya (caring), Ira (earth), Kabir (great), Kavya (poetry), Mira (light, ocean), Nila (blue), Omkar (sacred sound), Tara (star), Vihaan (dawn), Zoya (alive).

Growing — bump photos



12 weeks

16 weeks

20 weeks

28 weeks

34 weeks

38 weeks

My first ultrasound

Date · week

The day we met



Date & time of birth

Place

Weight & length

Who was there

The first thing I noticed about you

The first song we sang to you

How I felt

Our story

Our first photo together

Glossary



Abhyāsa अभ्यास — Steady, repeated practice.

Ānanda आनन्द — Joy, bliss; the innermost of the five kośas.

Anulom vilom अनुलोम विलोम — Alternate-nostril breathing (practised here without holding the breath).

Āśīrvāda आशीर्वाद — A blessing, usually given by elders.

Āyurveda आयुर्वेद — India's classical system of medicine, 'knowledge of life'.

Bhrāmari भ्रमरी — Humming-bee breath.

Bīja बीज — Seed; also a one-syllable 'seed' sound in mantra.

Bindu बिन्दु — The central point of a yantra or maṇḍala.

Cakra चक्र — 'Wheel'; a centre in the subtle-body maps of tantra (symbolic, not anatomical).

Dauhr̥da / Dohada दौहृद — Pregnancy cravings; the 'two-hearted' state of the mother.

Dhyāna ध्यान — Meditation; steady attention.

Garbha गर्भ — Womb; the developing baby.

Garbhiṇī गर्भिणी — A pregnant woman.

Garbha saṃskāra गर्भ संस्कार — Traditional ideas and practices for nurturing pregnancy and the unborn child.

Garbhiṇī paricaryā गर्भिणी परिचर्या — Ayurvedic care of the pregnant woman.

Godh bharaī गोद भराई — 'Filling the lap': a North Indian pregnancy celebration.

Kolam கோலம் — Threshold art drawn around dots (South India).

Kośa कोश — Sheath or layer (see Pañca Kośa).

Lorī लोरी — Lullaby (Hindi).

Maitrī मैत्री — Friendliness, loving-kindness.

Maṇḍala मण्डल — A circular sacred diagram; here, a pattern for colouring.

Mantra मन्त्र — A sacred word, verse or sound used in recitation or meditation.

Māsānumāsika मासानुमासिक — Month by month (as in the traditional month-wise regimen).

Mudrā मुद्रा — A gesture, especially of the hands.

Ojas ओजस् — In Ayurveda, the vital essence of strength and immunity.

Pañca Kośa पञ्च कोश — The five sheaths: body, breath, mind, wisdom, joy (Taittirīya Upaniṣad).

Prāṇa प्राण — Breath; life-force.

Prāṇāyāma प्राणायाम — Yogic breath practice.

Puṃsavana पुंसवन — An ancient 3rd-month rite; its old aim of a son is rejected here, and sex selection is illegal in India.

Rangoli रंगोळी — Coloured floor patterns (Maharashtra, Gujarat and beyond).

Saṅkalpa संकल्प — A heartfelt intention.

Saṃskāra संस्कार — A rite of passage; also an impression or refinement.

Śānti शान्ति — Peace.

Sīmantonayana सीमन्तोन्नयन — Vedic hair-parting rite in pregnancy, ancestor of godh bharaī, sīmantham and valaikāppu.

Śloka श्लोक — A verse, usually of two lines.

Śrī Yantra श्री यन्त्र — A yantra of nine interlocking triangles around a central point.

Tālāṭṭu தாலாட்டு — Lullaby (Tamil).

Trāṭaka त्राटक — Steady gazing; practised here gently, with soft eyes and normal blinking.

Upaniṣad उपनिषद् — Philosophical texts at the end of the Vedas.

Valaikāppu வளைகாப்பு — Tamil bangle ceremony for the mother-to-be.

Yantra यन्त्र — A geometric diagram used for contemplation.

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Links for every source are in research/research-notes.md. [needs verification] marks items awaiting expert review.

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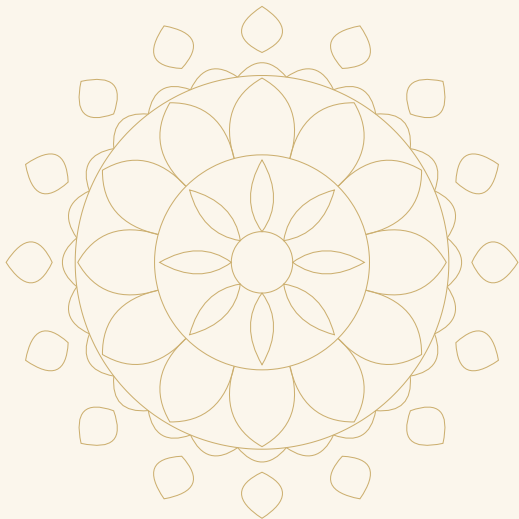
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Tradition vs evidence — at a glance

TRADITION SAYS	WHAT MODERN EVIDENCE SAYS	BADGE
Keep the mother cheerful and calm (Suśruta Śā. 10/3).	Maternal stress, anxiety and depression are linked with child outcomes; support and stress-reduction help mothers.	● Science-backed
The baby hears and learns in the womb (Abhimanyu, Prahlaḍa).	Yes for hearing: from ~19–24 weeks; newborns recognise mother’s voice and familiar passages. No evidence of learning skills or knowledge.	● Science-backed
Mantra chanting purifies or shapes the child.	Chanting and humming may calm the mother (slower breathing; small studies). No evidence of effects on a child’s character or intelligence.	● Emerging evidence
Month-wise milk, ghee and nourishing foods.	Adequate energy, protein and calcium matter; modern care adds iron, folate, iodine, DHA, B12 and food safety. Exact month-wise formulas are untested.	✦ Tradition & culture
Fulfil the mother’s cravings (dauhṛda).	Cravings are common and mostly harmless; craving clay, chalk or ice (pica) can signal iron deficiency — tell your doctor.	● Science-backed
Śimantonnayana with music and blessings.	Social support protects maternal mental health.	● Emerging evidence
Yoga in pregnancy.	Generally safe when adapted; benefits for stress and labour, with low-quality evidence. Avoid inversions, hot yoga and breath-holding.	● Emerging evidence
Yantras, cakras and mudrās.	No physiological evidence; valuable as contemplative, artistic and cultural practice.	✦ Tradition & culture
Taboos (eclipses, going out, certain sights).	No evidence; they increase fear and can restrict care. Not included.	⊗ Not included
Herbal rasāyanas, medicated ghee, basti.	Not tested for safety in pregnancy; some products contain heavy metals (Saper 2008). Not included.	⊗ Not included
Puṁsavana for a son.	Sex selection is illegal (PC&PNDT Act) and impossible by ritual. Reframed as a blessing for any child.	✦ Tradition & culture
The Abhimanyu story.	A much-loved folk tale (a later addition to the epic) — not a historical or medical account.	✦ Tradition & culture



Full evidence table with sources and confidence levels: [research/evidence-table.csv](#). Items marked [needs verification] are listed in [QA-report.md](#).

Index of activities

By evidence badge and time. Weeks where each activity appears are listed.



● Science-backed

Baby-talk moment (2 min) wk 17, 21
Ankle circles & calf stretch (5 min) wk 11, 33
Cat-cow (Mārjārī) (5 min) wk 12, 16
Gentle warrior II (5 min) wk 21
Lullaby in your mother tongue (5 min) wk 15, 22, 30, 37
Mountain & side stretch (5 min) wk 15
Natural belly breathing (5 min) wk 1–4, 5, 37, 40
Neck & shoulder release (5 min) wk 6, 13
Open seated twist (5 min) wk 27
Partner's voice for baby (5 min) wk 18, 19, 30
Pelvic-floor squeezes (5 min) wk 8, 24
Sing a lullaby (5 min) wk 16, 18, 26, 33, 39
Supported butterfly (5 min) wk 22, 31
Talk to your baby (5 min) wk 7, 11, 19
Wall pelvic tilts (5 min) wk 17, 29, 36
Indian story time (10 min) wk 14, 20, 25, 32
Partner task of the week (10 min) wk 11, 28
Reach out (10 min) wk 8, 39
Same story, same song (10 min) wk 28, 29, 31, 36, 38, 40
Side-lying rest (10 min) wk 9, 23, 28, 34, 38
Daily walk (20 min) wk 10, 14, 20, 32, 39
Calcium foods (meal) wk 13, 23, 32, 34
Choline foods (meal) wk 15, 30
Folate foods (meal) wk 1–4, 18, 26
Food safety (meal) wk 6
Iodised salt (meal) wk 9
Iron + vitamin C (meal) wk 12, 19, 28, 35, 39
Less caffeine (meal) wk 8
Omega-3 fats (meal) wk 14, 24, 31
Protein at every meal (meal) wk 10, 17, 20, 27, 29
Small, frequent meals (meal) wk 5
Tastes of home (meal) wk 11, 25, 38
Vitamin B12 (meal) wk 16, 22

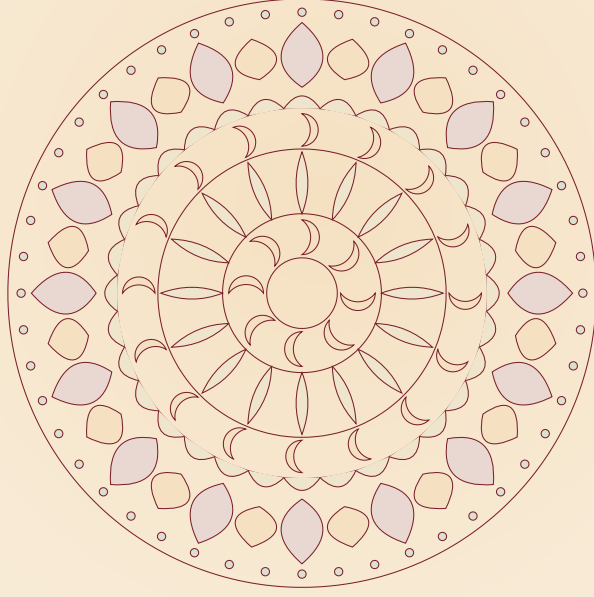
Water & fluids (meal) wk 7, 21, 33, 37, 40

🕒 Emerging evidence

Belly-touch hello (2 min) wk 9, 16, 25
One calm minute (2 min) wk 5, 12, 18, 28, 35, 38
A Śānti (peace) mantra (5 min) wk 5, 9, 34
Anulom vilom — no holding (5 min) wk 19
Bhrāmarī — humming bee (5 min) wk 7, 18, 30
Gāyatrī mantra (5 min) wk 24
Imagine meeting baby (5 min) wk 15, 22, 29, 37
Kind wishes (maitrī) (5 min) wk 11, 24, 31, 40
Lotus visualisation (5 min) wk 7, 16, 25, 37
Moon gazing (5 min) wk 23, 39
Soft Om chanting (5 min) wk 6
Three good things (5 min) wk 6, 14, 21, 26, 35
Tree pose at the wall (5 min) wk 25
Worry to wish (5 min) wk 5, 12, 24, 32
Letter to baby (10 min) wk 1–4, 7, 10, 13, 20, 27, 31, 38, 40
Partner foot & hand massage (10 min) wk 26
Record a voice message (10 min) wk 17, 23, 36
Mindful meal (15 min) wk 36
Calm music break (20 min) wk 1–4, 10, 23
Guided relaxation (yoga nidrā) (20 min) wk 35
Mandala colouring (20 min) wk 8, 14, 21, 29
Sound bath (20 min) wk 12, 35

✦ Tradition & culture

Mudrā & breath (2 min) wk 6, 13, 22, 32, 36
Soft gaze at a yantra (3 min) wk 19, 26
A family blessing (5 min) wk 33, 34
Cakra check-in (5 min) wk 10, 17, 33
Five-layer check-in (Pañca Kośa) (5 min) wk 1–4
Madālasā's lullaby (5 min) wk 27
Wisdom line of the week (5 min) wk 8, 13
Kolam on dots (10 min) wk 9, 15, 27, 34
Trace the Śrī Yantra (20 min) wk 20, 30



सर्वे भवन्तु सुखिनः । सर्वे सन्तु निरामयाः ।
सर्वे भद्राणि पश्यन्तु । मा कश्चिद्दुःखभाग्भवेत् ॥

*May all be happy; may all be free from illness; may all see what is good; may
no one suffer.*

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